



**Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services  
Center for Medicare and  
Medicaid Innovation**

# **Wasteful and Inappropriate Service Reduction (WISeR) Model**

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## **Provider and Supplier Operational Guide**

**Version 6.0**

***Last Updated: April 24, 2026***

## Summary of Changes

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Version 6.0 of the WISeR Provider and Supplier Operational Guide includes modifications to select codes and documentation requirements.

### Version History

| Version Number | Date of Update    | Description of Change                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.0            | October 10, 2025  | N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 2.0            | November 6, 2025  | Amends Appendix B, WISeR Associated Codes List<br><br>Clarifies coding guidance for permanent implementation for Sacral Nerve Stimulation for Urinary Incontinence (Section 6.2.7) and Hypoglossal Nerve Stimulation for Obstructive Sleep Apnea (Tables A12 and C1)                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 3.0            | December 23, 2025 | Delays implementation of the Percutaneous Image-Guided Lumbar Decompression for Lumbar Spinal Stenosis in WISeR (Section 6)<br><br>Adds WISeR Participant Contact Information (Section 3.3)<br><br>Removes Current Procedural Terminology (CPT) 22585 as a code requiring prior authorization and pre-payment review in Appendix A and relevant associated codes in Appendix B<br><br>Amends Appendix B (WISeR Associated Codes List) as well as select Required Documentation (Section 6.2) |

| Version Number | Date of Update    | Description of Change                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4.0            | February 12, 2026 | <p>Updates WISeR Participant and MAC contact information (Sections 3.3 and 3.4)</p> <p>Clarifies provisional partial affirmation and dismissal decision types (Section 4.1)</p> <p>Adds high-level information about the exemption program (Section 5)</p> <p>Reorders Appendices B and C: Appendix B now contains ICD-10 Indications for Relevant WISeR Items and Services, and Appendix C contains the WISeR Associated Codes List</p> <p>Removes ICD-10 code G47.33 as an indication for Vagus Nerve Stimulator requiring prior authorization and pre-payment review in Appendix B</p> <p>Removes CPT codes C5271 through C5278 as skin substitute codes requiring prior authorization and pre-payment review in Appendix A and relevant associated codes in Appendix C</p> |
| 5.0            | March 12, 2026    | <p>Updates WISeR Participant contact information (Sections 3.3)</p> <p>Clarifies indications for CPT 62323 that are out of scope for WISeR (Section 6.2 and Appendix A)</p> <p>Amends Appendix A (WISeR Select Items and Services) for Hypoglossal Nerve Stimulation for the Treatment of Obstructive Sleep Apnea to include new HCPCS codes</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

| Version Number | Date of Update | Description of Change                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6.0            | April 24, 2026 | <p data-bbox="716 201 1435 317">Updates documentation requirements for Epidural Steroid Injections for Pain Management (Section 6.2.10)</p> <p data-bbox="716 348 1435 464">Clarifies date guidance in Appendix A for HCPCS codes C8007 and C8011 for Hypoglossal Nerve Stimulation for the Treatment of Obstructive Sleep Apnea</p> <p data-bbox="716 495 1435 611">Removes ICD-10 codes L97.111-L97.826 as indications for skin substitutes requiring prior authorization and pre-payment review in Appendix B</p> <p data-bbox="716 642 1435 716">Removes HCPCS codes Q4100 and Q4106 as associated codes for skin substitutes in Appendix C</p> |

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## Purpose

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The Center for Medicare and Medicaid Innovation (CMMI) was established to test new payment and service delivery models that reduce Medicare and Medicaid costs while maintaining or improving the quality of care. The structure of Original Medicare often leads to unnecessary treatments and increases the risk of waste, fraud, and abuse. The Wasteful and Inappropriate Service Reduction (WISeR) Model tests the use of enhanced technologies, such as artificial intelligence and machine learning tools, to ensure that items and services furnished to beneficiaries in Original Medicare are in line with existing Medicare coverage criteria by working with organizations skilled in these technologies to improve the efficiency and accuracy of medical reviews. By focusing on services vulnerable to fraud and waste, the model seeks to decrease clinically inappropriate care and protect beneficiaries while ensuring continued access to appropriate services.

The purpose of the Provider and Supplier Operational Guide is to provide a practical overview of the prior authorization submission and determination process for Medicare-enrolled providers and suppliers that furnish and bill items and services included in the WISeR Model in the states in which the WISeR Model is being tested. The guide also addresses the pre-payment medical review process that will be triggered if claims for items and services included in the WISeR Model in states where the WISeR Model is operating are submitted without first obtaining prior authorization.

## Select Statutory Medicare Requirements

For any service or item to be covered by Medicare, it must:

- Be eligible for a defined Medicare benefit category
- Be reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis or treatment of illness or injury or to improve the functioning of a malformed body member
- Meet all other applicable Medicare statutory and regulatory requirements

Social Security Act (Title XVIII) Standard References:<sup>1 2 3</sup>

- Title XVIII of the Social Security Act, Section 1862(a)(1)(A), states that no Medicare payment shall be made for items or services which are not reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis or treatment of illness or injury.
- Title XVIII of the Social Security Act, Section 1862(a)(1)(E), states that no Medicare payment shall be made in the case of research conducted pursuant to Section 1142 of the Act except for items and services that are reasonable and necessary to carry out that section.
- Title XVIII of Social Security Act, Section 1862(a)(10), states that no payment may be made under Part A or Part B for any expenses incurred for items or services where such expenses are for cosmetic surgery or are incurred in connection with cosmetic surgery, except as required for the prompt repair of accidental injury or improvement of the functioning of a malformed body member.

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<sup>1</sup> Title XVIII of the Social Security Act, Section 1862, is available at [Social Security Administration Website, Section 1862](#).

<sup>2</sup> Title XVIII of the Social Security Act, Section 1833, is available at [Social Security Administration Website, Section 1833](#).

<sup>3</sup> Title XI of the Social Security Act, Section 1115A, is available at [Social Security Administration Website, Section 1115A](#).



- Title XVIII of the Social Security Act, Section 1833(e), states that no payment shall be made to any provider for any claim that lacks the necessary information to process the claim.
- Title XI of the Social Security Act, Section 1115A, authorizes the CMS Innovation Center to test innovative payment and service delivery models that aim to reduce program expenditures while preserving or enhancing the quality of care for individuals under Medicare, Medicaid, or the Children’s Health Insurance Program.

#### Statutory Waiver Authority:

Section 1115A(d)(1) of the Act authorizes the Secretary to waive such requirements of Titles XI and XVIII and of Sections 1902(a)(1), 1902(a)(13), and 1903(m)(2)(A)(iii) of the Act as may be necessary solely for purposes of carrying out Section 1115A of the Act with respect to testing models described in Section 1115A(b) of the Act. For this model, consistent with this standard, such provisions of Sections 1834(a)(15) and 1869(h) of the Act will be waived that limit the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services’ (CMS) ability to conduct prior authorization. Although these provisions are specific to durable medical equipment and physician services, any portion of these sections as well as any portion of 42 CFR 410.20(d), which implements Section 1869(h) of the Act, and 42 CFR 414.234, which implements Section 1834(a)(15) of the Act, will be waived if they could be construed to limit CMS’ ability to conduct prior authorization for other items or services or they could be construed to restrict what entity performs said prior authorization.

## WISeR Quick Reference for Providers and Suppliers

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Starting on January 5, 2026, for dates of service on or after January 15, 2026, select items and services covered under Original Medicare will be subject to prior authorization or pre-payment medical review under the WISeR Model.

The answers to the following two questions determine whether a provider or supplier will be impacted by the WISeR Model. Impacted providers and suppliers will have the option to either complete the prior authorization request or undergo pre-payment medical review prior to claims payment for these items and services:

- Does the supplier or provider practice in Arizona, New Jersey, Ohio, Oklahoma, Texas, or Washington?
- Will the provider or supplier deliver at least one of the WISeR Select Items and Services listed in Appendix A to Original Medicare beneficiaries? Of note, patients with Medicare Advantage and Railroad Medicare beneficiaries are not impacted by the WISeR Model.

If the provider or supplier answers yes to both questions, the provider or supplier is included in the WISeR Model and will have two options to demonstrate medical necessity requirements when delivering WISeR Select Items and Services throughout the model’s duration:

1. Submit a prior authorization request for the WISeR item or service directly to the WISeR Participant in their state or to their regularly assigned Medicare Administrative Contractor (MAC).
2. Provide the WISeR item or perform the WISeR service and submit a claim without prior authorization. Claims submitted without prior authorization will be subject to pre-payment

medical review. The WISeR Participant will contact the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier to request the relevant clinical documentation related to the claim.

Requests for either option can be sent to the MAC or WISeR Participant by mail, fax, or Electronic Submission of Medical Documentation (esMD), or via the electronic portal.

WISeR does not change Medicare benefits or coverage requirements. The WISeR Participant will use existing National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) and the clinical documentation submitted by the provider or supplier to determine whether to issue a provisional affirmation or non-affirmation for each prior authorization request. The WISeR Participant will also use NCDs and LCDs in combination with the submitted clinical documentation to determine whether the service billed was medically necessary and payable. Determinations are expected to be made within the following time frames:

- For prior authorization requests, WISeR Participants will plan to issue a determination to the requester within 3 calendar days of receiving the initial or resubmitted request. Expedited requests will be completed within 2 calendar days.
- For pre-payment medical review, WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers will have 45 calendar days from the date of the request for documentation from the WISeR Participant to submit their clinical documentation. WISeR Participants will issue a determination on medical necessity to the MAC within 3 calendar days of receipt of all documentation.

The WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier may resubmit the prior authorization request and may include additional information to support the resubmission if they receive a non-affirmation decision. There is no limit to the number of times a particular prior authorization request can be resubmitted. With a resubmission, the requester will also have the opportunity to request peer-to-peer clinical review to inform the new determination. If the pre-payment medical review results in a claim denial, the provider or supplier can appeal the denial using the existing Medicare appeals process. WISeR preserves all Medicare appeals rights for providers and beneficiaries.

## Section 1. Model Overview

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The Wasteful and Inappropriate Service Reduction (WISeR) Model aims to help ensure people with Original Medicare receive safe, effective, and necessary care. The WISeR Model tests the implementation of technology-enhanced prior authorization and pre-payment medical review for WISeR Select Items and Services in limited geographic regions to help patients and providers avoid unnecessary or inappropriate care while safeguarding federal taxpayer dollars. Importantly, the WISeR Model does not change existing Original Medicare coverage or payment policies, and providers and beneficiaries still retain their rights to appeal any denied claims.

### 1.1. WISeR Participants

Participants in the WISeR Model are companies with expertise managing prior authorization for other payers using enhanced technology, such as artificial intelligence, to streamline medical review. In this guide, we use the term “WISeR Participants” to refer to these companies. The WISeR Model has six states and six WISeR Participants. Each WISeR Participant has been assigned to manage prior authorization and pre-payment review for WISeR Select Items and Services in one state.

WISeR Participants will work closely with the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) Medicare Administrative Contractors (MACs) in their assigned states, establishing formal Business Associate Agreements in compliance with the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act and privacy laws. WISeR Participants will also work with their assigned MACs to coordinate data flows so that WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers are not required to change their usual processes if they choose to submit information directly to MACs.

### 1.2. WISeR Beneficiaries, WISeR Providers, and WISeR Suppliers

Original Medicare–enrolled providers and suppliers in WISeR Participants’ jurisdictions who furnish WISeR Select Items and Services to Original Medicare beneficiaries will be referred to as “WISeR Providers” and “WISeR Suppliers.” Railroad Medicare beneficiaries are excluded from the WISeR Model.

WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers will have the option to submit prior authorization requests (as detailed in Section 3) for the WISeR Select Items and Services before delivering those WISeR Select Items and Services to WISeR Beneficiaries. A “WISeR Beneficiary” is an individual who is enrolled in Original Medicare and receives WISeR Select Items and Services from a WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier who provides the item or service in a state that is included in the WISeR Model.

### 1.3. Prior Authorization and Pre-Payment Medical Review Process

WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers who request prior authorization will have their requests processed by their designated WISeR Participant, who will issue a decision (affirmed or non-affirmed), as detailed in Section 4. Non-affirmed decisions may be resubmitted, during which time WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers may request peer-to-peer review (see Section 4.4 for additional information).

If WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers furnish WISeR Select Items and Services without prior authorization, those claims will be routed to the WISeR Participant for pre-payment medical review,

and the WISeR Participant will request documentation to support the medical necessity of the care before the claim is paid or denied (See Section 7.2).

Throughout the prior authorization and pre-payment medical review processes, WISeR Participants will use appropriately trained clinicians, as applicable, to verify that WISeR Select Items and Services that are requested or furnished meet Medicare coverage criteria. These clinicians will have subject matter expertise relevant to the type of care under review.

## 1.4. Model Timeline and Scope

The WISeR Model will be implemented on January 1, 2026. WISeR Participants and MACs will not begin accepting prior authorization requests from WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers until January 5, 2026. This later date is intentional and is designed to provide sufficient lead time to process requests and ensure adequate time to schedule affirmed services. Please note that prior authorization requests submitted on or after January 5, 2026, will apply to services rendered on or after January 15, 2026. The WISeR Model will run through December 31, 2031.

Six states across four MAC jurisdictions have been selected for the WISeR Model. These states are collectively referred to as “WISeR Jurisdictions”:

- New Jersey (JL/Novitas Solutions, Inc.)
- Ohio (J15/CGS Administrators, LLC)
- Oklahoma and Texas (JH/Novitas)
- Arizona and Washington (JF/Noridian)

## 1.5. Included Items and Services and Sites of Service

The WISeR prior authorization and pre-payment medical review process will apply to the WISeR Select Items and Services list (Appendix A) for services delivered in a state selected for the WISeR Model. These WISeR Select Items and Services were selected based on three key criteria:

1. They have existing, publicly available coverage criteria.
2. They are typically elective, not first-line diagnostics or treatments for a medical condition, and may pose concerns related to patient safety if delivered inappropriately.
3. They are of sufficient volume or dollar value to ensure adequate WISeR Model impact and may involve prior reports of potential fraud, waste, and abuse.

First and foremost, WISeR Participants will follow coding and clinical guidance in the selected National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) or Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs). For a subset of WISeR Select Items and Services, prior authorization and pre-payment review will be limited to certain indications as specified in the NCDs and LCDs; ICD-10<sup>4</sup> codes for those relevant WISeR Select Items and Services are listed in Appendix B. Additionally, for services that involve a trial before permanent implantation of a device, WISeR will initially implement prior authorization and pre-payment medical review for the permanent implantation only. More information is detailed in Section 6 of this guide.

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<sup>4</sup> ICD-10 refers to the International Classification of Diseases and Related Health Problems, 10th Revision.

WISeR does not overlap with existing CMS prior authorization programs (e.g., the Prior Authorization Program for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department [OPD] Services) and excludes any Current Procedural Terminology (CPT) and Healthcare Common Procedure Coding System (HCPCS) codes already subject to prior authorization under existing CMS programs. If applicable, providers and suppliers should continue submitting prior authorization requests for those CPT/HCPCS codes (e.g., CPT code 63650) as part of those existing programs.

CMS may update the WISeR Select Items and Services list during the WISeR Model's performance period. The addition of services to the WISeR Model does not alter Medicare benefit or coverage requirements, nor does it create new documentation requirements for WISeR Providers or WISeR Suppliers. Any documentation required for prior authorization consists of information that providers and suppliers are regularly required to maintain for Medicare payment purposes. Although the WISeR Participants or the items and services included in the WISeR Model might change, any changes would be communicated to WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers in a timely manner.

The WISeR Model will include items and services rendered at select sites of service, as defined by the Type of Bill (TOB) and/or Place of Service (POS) code. The sites of service included are Hospital OPD (TOB 13X for facility claims, corresponding to POS 19 and 22 on professional claims), Ambulatory Surgery Center (ASC) (POS 24), home (POS 12), and office (POS 11). For items and services delivered in the Hospital OPD and ASC settings, WISeR will include and select facility-based encounters and claims, rather than professional services.

## 1.6. Inquiries Regarding the Model

Providers and suppliers who have questions about the WISeR prior authorization and pre-payment medical review process should contact the WISeR Participant assigned to their MAC jurisdiction. The WISeR Participant will provide additional education to WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers about the prior authorization and medical review process. WISeR Participant contact information is available in Section 3.3. Please also note that the WISeR Help Desk is unable to provide support for an individual participant's portals or verify prior authorization requests.

## Section 2. Pathways to Coverage Determination Under WISeR

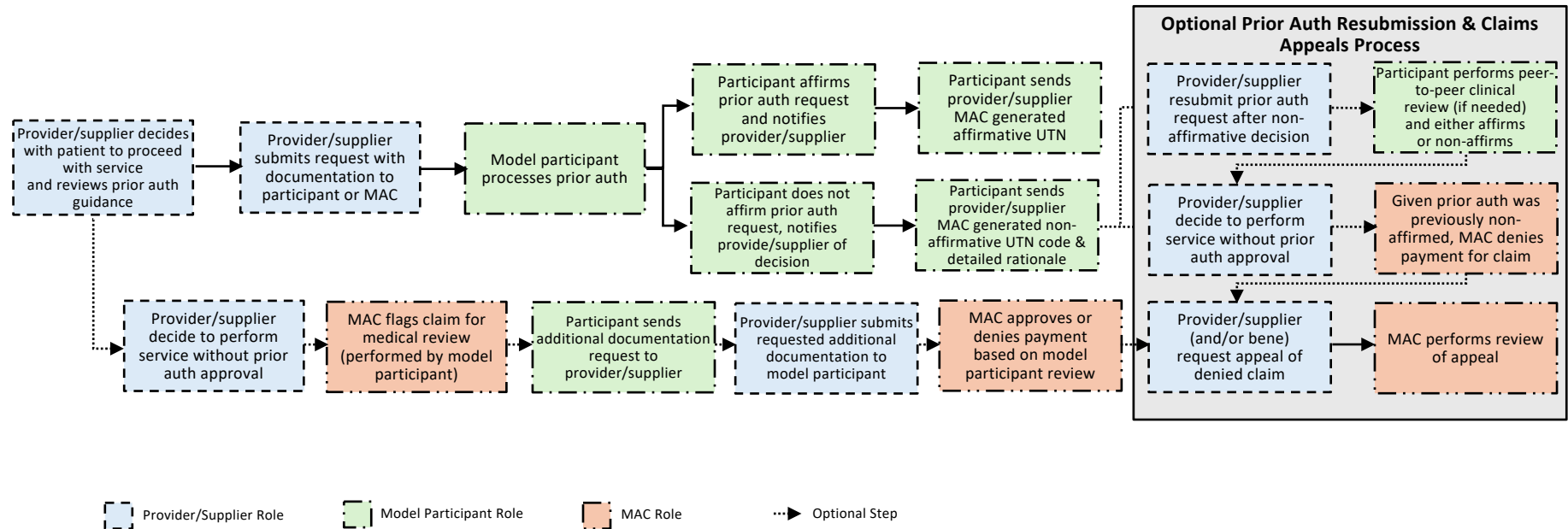
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WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers will have two options under WISeR to receive coverage determinations:

1. Submit a prior authorization request to receive a determination before administering WISeR Select Items and Services, as described in Sections 3 and 4.
2. Furnish WISeR Select Items and Services immediately and wait for the determination through pre-payment review, as described in Section 7.2.

Figure 1 displays the prior authorization and pre-payment medical review workflow.

**Figure 1. WISeR Model workflow**



## Section 3. Submitting a Prior Authorization Request

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Under the WISeR Model, a prior authorization request by the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier will result in a provisional affirmation or non-affirmation of Medicare coverage for WISeR Select Items and Services listed in Appendix A. WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers will have two options for submitting a prior authorization request:

1. Submit a prior authorization request directly to the WISeR Participant.
2. Submit a prior authorization request to their designated MAC. The MAC will forward the request to the WISeR Participant within 1 calendar day, or as soon as practicable.

Each prior authorization request must:

1. Pertain to one WISeR Select Item or Service in Appendix A.
2. Be submitted in advance of furnishing the item or service to the WISeR Beneficiary and before submitting the claim for processing.
3. Contain a common set of standard data elements listed in Section 3.2.
4. Include all documentation necessary to show compliance with applicable Medicare coverage criteria, including coding, and payment rules. See Section 6 for additional details on the documentation requirements.

If a WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier intends to bill multiple affirmed services on the same claim in the Hospital OPD setting, the services must be included on the same prior authorization request and have the same unique tracking number (UTN).

Note that in lieu of requesting prior authorization for WISeR Select Items and Services, WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers may choose to provide the select item or service without prior authorization and submit the claim for payment. In this case, the MAC will suspend the claim and forward it to the WISeR Participant for pre-payment medical review. See Section 7.2 for additional information on the pre-payment medical review process.

The term “requester” will be used throughout this document to describe the person or entity that submits the prior authorization request, documentation, and/or claims.

### 3.1. Initial Prior Authorization Requests and Resubmissions

An initial prior authorization submission is the first prior authorization request sent to the WISeR Participant for review and decision.

If the initial prior authorization request is non-affirmed, the requester may submit a subsequent submission (also known as a resubmission) with additional and/or updated documentation to correct an error or omission identified by the WISeR Participant during its initial review.

### 3.2. General Prior Authorization Request Documentation

Requesters must include the data elements listed in Table 1 in all prior authorization requests to avoid potential processing delays.

**Table 1. Required data elements for prior authorization requests**

| Category                                                          | Required data element                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WISeR Beneficiary Information (as written on their Medicare card) | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Beneficiary name</li><li>• Beneficiary Medicare number (also known as the MBI)</li><li>• Beneficiary date of birth</li><li>• Beneficiary address</li><li>• Beneficiary email address (optional)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Facility Information (if applicable)                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Name of facility</li><li>• Provider Transaction Access Number (PTAN)/CMS Certification Number (CCN)</li><li>• Facility address</li><li>• Facility National Provider Identifier (NPI)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Physician/Practitioner Information                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Physician/practitioner name</li><li>• Physician/practitioner NPI</li><li>• Physician/practitioner PTAN</li><li>• Physician/practitioner address</li><li>• Physician/practitioner fax number (optional)</li><li>• Physician/practitioner email address (optional)</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Requester Information                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Requester name</li><li>• Requester phone number</li><li>• Requester email address</li><li>• Requester fax number</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Other Supporting Information                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• CPT/HCPCS code(s) for the WISeR Select Item or Service being submitted for prior authorization</li><li>• Diagnosis code(s) pertinent to the WISeR Select Item or Service</li><li>• Anticipated Place of Service or facility type</li><li>• Units of service (to be performed within 120 days of the decision)</li><li>• Indication of whether the request is an initial review or a resubmission</li><li>• Indication of whether the request should be expedited to avoid jeopardizing the life or health of the WISeR Beneficiary and the reason for the expedited service</li><li>• Clinical documentation requirements specific to the selected item or service</li><li>• Other information as directed by the WISeR Participant</li></ul> |

Note: CPT = Current Procedural Terminology; HCPCS = Healthcare Common Procedure Coding System.

For resubmissions, in addition to the required data elements in Table 1, requesters must also include an exact match of the WISeR Beneficiary's first name, last name, date of birth, and the UTN associated with the previous submission. WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers should look at the initial decision notification for the UTN.



### 3.3. Sending a Prior Authorization Request to the WISeR Participant

Requesters can submit prior authorization requests directly to WISeR Participants. WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers are encouraged to use electronic delivery when possible to avoid potential delays with fax and mailing. When submitting prior authorization requests via fax, place the prior authorization form on the page immediately after the fax cover sheet. WISeR Participants' contact information (as of March 12, 2026) is included in Table 2; this table will be maintained and updated throughout the WISeR Model as needed.

**Table 2. WISeR Participant contact information**

| Model participant, website                                           | State      | Contact information                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cohere Health, Inc.<br><a href="#">Link to Cohere Health website</a> | Texas      | Telephone: 855-430-6299; fax: 404-835-8325<br>Email: <a href="mailto:wisersupport@coherehealth.com">wisersupport@coherehealth.com</a><br>Web portal: <a href="https://next.coherehealth.com/">https://next.coherehealth.com/</a>               |
| Genzeon Corporation<br><a href="#">Link to Genzeon website</a>       | New Jersey | Telephone: 484-713-9291; fax: 484-200-2155<br>Email: <a href="mailto:wisershelpdesk@genzeon.com">wisershelpdesk@genzeon.com</a><br>Web portal: <a href="https://portal.hip.one">https://portal.hip.one</a>                                     |
| Humata Health, Inc.<br><a href="#">Link to Humata Health website</a> | Oklahoma   | Telephone: 407-308-0378; fax: 617-843-6857<br>Email: <a href="mailto:wisersupport@humatahealth.com">wisersupport@humatahealth.com</a><br>Web portal: <a href="https://psi.humatahealth.com/login">https://psi.humatahealth.com/login</a>       |
| Innovaccer Inc.<br><a href="#">Link to Innovaccer website</a>        | Ohio       | Telephone: 202-796-1619<br>Email: <a href="mailto:ohcmswisers-inquiry@innovaccer.com">ohcmswisers-inquiry@innovaccer.com</a><br>Web portal: <a href="https://wisers.innovaccer.us">https://wisers.innovaccer.us</a>                            |
| Virtix Health LLC<br><a href="#">Link to Virtix Health website</a>   | Washington | Telephone: 833-943-2209<br>Email: <a href="mailto:wisersupport@virtixhealth.com">wisersupport@virtixhealth.com</a><br>Web portal: <a href="https://wisers.portal.virtixhealth.com/login">https://wisers.portal.virtixhealth.com/login</a>      |
| Zyter Inc.<br><a href="#">Link to Zyter Website</a>                  | Arizona    | Telephone: 202-773-1430; fax: 667-407-1889<br>Email: <a href="mailto:wisers@zyter.com">wisers@zyter.com</a><br>Web portal: <a href="https://zytercms.gov.hosted.health/proauth/sign-in">https://zytercms.gov.hosted.health/proauth/sign-in</a> |

### 3.4. Sending a Prior Authorization Request to the MAC

Requesters have the following options for submitting prior authorization requests to the Medicare Part A and Part B MACs (A/B MACs):<sup>5</sup>

1. Fax<sup>6</sup>

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<sup>5</sup> A/B MACs process Part A and Part B claims for a defined jurisdiction and service institutional providers, physicians, practitioners, and suppliers. See [What's a MAC](#) for more information.

<sup>6</sup> When submitting prior authorization requests via fax, place the prior authorization form on the page immediately after the fax cover sheet.

2. Electronic Submission of Medical Documentation (esMD)<sup>7</sup>
3. Mail
4. MAC electronic portal (A/B MAC specific)

WISer Providers and WISer Suppliers are encouraged to use electronic delivery to avoid mailing delays. MAC contact information is included in Table 3.

**Table 3. MAC contact information**

| MAC jurisdiction, state(s), website                                                                          | Telephone and fax numbers                                      | Mailing address                                                                                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| JF (Noridian Healthcare Solutions LLC)<br>Arizona and Washington<br><a href="#">Link to Noridian Website</a> | Customer Service: 877-908-8431<br>Fax: 701-277-7852            | Noridian JF Part B<br>PO Box 6700<br>Fargo, ND 58108-6700                                      |
| J15 (CGS)<br>Ohio<br><a href="#">Link to CGS Website</a>                                                     | Customer Service: 866-276-9558<br>Fax: 615-660-5300            | CGS Administrators, LLC<br>J15 Part B Correspondence<br>PO Box 20018<br>Nashville, TN 37202    |
| JL (Novitas Solutions)<br>New Jersey<br><a href="#">Link to Novitas Solutions Website (JL)</a>               | Prior Auth Customer Service: 855-340-5975<br>Fax: 833-200-9268 | Novitas Solutions<br>JL Prior Authorization Requests<br>PO Box 3702<br>Mechanicsburg, PA 17055 |
| JH (Novitas Solutions)<br>Oklahoma and Texas<br><a href="#">Link to Novitas Solutions Website (JH)</a>       | Prior Auth Customer Service: 855-340-5975<br>Fax: 833-200-9268 | Novitas Solutions<br>JH Prior Authorization Requests<br>PO Box 3702<br>Mechanicsburg, PA 17055 |

## Section 4. Prior Authorization Review

Once the requester submits the prior authorization request, the WISer Participant will review the information submitted and issue a prior authorization decision (affirmation or non-affirmation) to the requester.

Each prior authorization request will be assigned a UTN generated by the MAC. If available, the WISer Participant will share this UTN number with the requester when the WISer Participant sends the prior authorization determination. **It is possible to receive a determination before the MAC generates a UTN. If this occurs, the requester should wait for the UTN and not resubmit the request until it has been received** (see Sections 3.1 and 3.2 for the required data elements that requesters must include). For questions or further assistance, please contact the participant and/or the MAC (see Sections 3.3 and 3.4 for contact information). WISer Providers and WISer Suppliers will need to ensure the UTN is included on each submitted claim if the service is rendered, regardless of whether the prior authorization request determination is an affirmation or non-affirmation (see Section 7 for details on the claim submission process).

<sup>7</sup> For more information about submissions through esMD, see [the CMS esMD website](#) or contact the appropriate MAC.

## 4.1. Prior Authorization Decision Types

### 4.1.1. *Provisional Affirmation*

A provisional affirmation is a preliminary finding that a future claim submitted to Medicare for the WISer Select Item or Service likely meets Medicare's coverage criteria, including coding and payment rules in Chapter IV of Title 42 or in Title XVIII of the Act, and that the WISer Select Item or Service is appropriate for the WISer Beneficiary.

The WISer Participant will issue a provisional affirmation to the requester, with a copy to the WISer Beneficiary, if it is decided that applicable Medicare coverage, coding, and payment rules are met. In general, the WISer Participant will aim to send the determination to the requester through the same method the requester originally used to submit the request (e.g., via postmark, fax, or electronic delivery) and within the time frames discussed in Section 4.2. For requests sent directly to the MAC via their MAC-specific electronic portal or esMD, the WISer Participant will aim to send the determination to the requestor via fax or another means of delivery using the contact information supplied by the requestor.

Provisional affirmation prior authorization decisions are valid for 120 days from the date that the decision was made. Services that are affirmed but not delivered before the 120-day window expires will require a new prior authorization request.

### 4.1.2. *Non-affirmation*

A non-affirmation prior authorization decision is a preliminary finding that a future claim submitted to Medicare for the requested item or service likely does not meet Medicare's applicable coverage criteria, including coding and payment rules in Chapter IV of Title 42 or in Title XVIII of the Act, and that the WISer Select Item or Service is not appropriate for the WISer Beneficiary.

The WISer Participant will issue a non-affirmation prior authorization decision to the requester, with a copy to the WISer Beneficiary if it is decided that applicable Medicare coverage, coding, and payment rules are not met. If the prior authorization review results in a non-affirmed decision, the WISer Participant will provide detailed information about all missing and/or noncompliant information that led to the decision, as well as instructions for resubmission. In general, the WISer Participant will aim to send the non-affirmation decision to the requester through the same method the requester originally used to submit the request (e.g., via postmark, fax, or electronic delivery) and within the time frames discussed in Section 4.2. For requests sent directly to the MAC via their MAC-specific electronic portal or esMD, the WISer Participant will aim to send the determination to the requestor via fax or another means of delivery using the contact information supplied by the requestor.

For non-affirmations, the WISer Model requires that the WISer Participant have human clinicians with relevant clinical expertise review the determination before it is issued.

Note that if a prior authorization request includes multiple WISer item or service codes, the non-affirmation of one item or service will result in the non-affirmation of the entire prior authorization request. Providers and suppliers will be able to submit items and services that meet criteria to be affirmed in a resubmission.

### **4.1.3. Provisional Partial Affirmation**

Effective April 1, 2026, a provisional partial affirmation decision means that one or more services on the prior authorization request received a provisional affirmation decision, and one or more services received a non-affirmation decision.

WISer Participants will follow the same process for any service(s) within the prior authorization request that receives a provisional affirmation decision, as described in Section 4.1.1, and for any service(s) that receives a non-affirmation decision, as described in Section 4.1.2.

### **4.1.4. Dismissal**

A prior authorization request is dismissed when certain information required to process the request (e.g., MBI) is incomplete or invalid, or when the request does not fall within the scope of WISer. Duplicate prior authorization requests are also subject to dismissal. A duplicate is a new prior authorization request submitted by the same WISer Provider/Supplier for the identical WISer Beneficiary and Select Item or Service before the WISer Participant has issued a determination for any earlier prior authorization request(s). The model participant will notify the submitter that their request was dismissed and the reason for the dismissal. Dismissed prior authorization requests are not reviewed for medical necessity. When a prior authorization request is dismissed, the submitter should review the reason listed in the dismissal letter. The submitter may then correct the error and submit the request again using the same submission procedures. When sending the corrections, the submitter must include all original documentation. If the dismissed request was an initial request, the subsequent request should be marked as an initial request. Table 4 presents several common dismissal reasons and steps to resolve.

**Table 4. Common dismissal reasons and corrective actions**

| <b>Dismissal reason</b>                                                        | <b>Additional explanation</b>                                                                            | <b>Steps to resolve</b>                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The request was submitted to the incorrect WISer Participant or MAC.           | A WISer Participant and MAC are associated with each state that is in the WISer Model.                   | Submit the request to the correct WISer Participant or MAC responsible for processing requests for the state in which the service is being delivered. |
| The request is for a non-WISer service.                                        | Only the items and services defined in Appendix A are subject to prior authorization review under WISer. | None. The service is not subject to prior authorization review under WISer.                                                                           |
| The beneficiary has a Medicare Advantage Plan or Medicaid.                     | WISer applies to Medicare Fee-for-Service beneficiaries.                                                 | Contact the individual Medicare Advantage or Medicaid Plan for information on their PARs.                                                             |
| The request contains an invalid, missing, or deceased MBI or beneficiary name. | Providers must include certain data elements in a PAR to be processed.                                   | Submit a new request with the corrected information.                                                                                                  |

| Dismissal reason                                                 | Additional explanation                                                                                                                                                                 | Steps to resolve                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Invalid or missing billing information (PTAN, NPI, or TOB code). | Providers must include certain billing information in a PAR to be processed.                                                                                                           | Verify the required information and resubmit the PAR.        |
| The PAR was submitted by an ineligible provider.                 | The WISeR Model only applies to providers and suppliers who meet the criteria described in the WISeR Quick Reference for Providers and Suppliers section, part of the Purpose section. | Render the service and follow your standard billing process. |
| The PAR was submitted by an exempt provider.                     | Exempt providers do not need to submit PARs.                                                                                                                                           | Render the service and follow your standard billing process. |

*Note:* CPT = Current Procedural Terminology; HCPCS = Healthcare Common Procedure Coding System; MAC = Medicare Administrative Contractor; MBI = Medicare Beneficiary Identifier; NPI = National Provider Identifier; OPD = Outpatient Department; PAR = prior authorization request; PTAN = Provider Transaction Access Number; TOB = Type of Bill; UTN = Unique Tracking Number.

## 4.2. Review Time Frames

### 4.2.1 Standard WISeR Prior Authorization Review Time Frame

WISeR Participants will typically issue a determination to the requester within 3 calendar days of receiving the initial or resubmitted request. The determination will be sent in the same manner in which the prior authorization request was submitted (e.g., via postmark, fax, or electronic delivery).

### 4.2.2. Expedited WISeR Prior Authorization Review

The requester may submit a prior authorization request for expedited review with the applicable documentation if delays could seriously jeopardize the WISeR Beneficiary's life, health, or ability to regain maximum function. If the WISeR Participant confirms this risk, the WISeR Participant will process the prior authorization request and communicate a decision to the requester within 2 days of receipt of the expedited request. If the WISeR Participant does not confirm the risk, the request will be processed under the standard timeframe (as defined in Section 4.2.1), and the WISeR Participant will notify the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier of the reclassification to the standard timeframe.

The determination will be sent to the requester in the same manner in which the prior authorization request was submitted (e.g., via postmark, fax, or electronic delivery). To avoid delays with mailing, WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers are encouraged to use fax, esMD, or a relevant electronic portal.

In expedited circumstances, the WISeR Participant may issue a determination to the requester before a UTN is generated and assigned to the prior authorization request. To prevent the claim for an affirmed, expedited service from being denied upon submission, the requester should hold their claim and not submit it for payment until the UTN is provided. The MAC will follow the standard process to obtain a UTN from CMS shared systems and then share the UTN with the requester once it is available.

### 4.3. Validation Period for Prior Authorization Decisions

Once a prior authorization request is approved, the UTN associated with it is valid for 120 calendar days starting from the decision date (the date it was approved). For example, if the prior authorization request is affirmed on January 5, 2026, the prior authorization and associated UTN (which must be included on the claim for the service) will be valid for dates of service through May 4, 2026. Otherwise, the provider will need to submit a new prior authorization request and obtain a new UTN.

For WISeR Select Items or Services (e.g., skin substitutes) when the prior authorization request is affirmed for repeat instances, the same UTN should be submitted with each claim for up to 120 days after the date of determination.

### 4.4. Resubmissions and Peer-to-Peer Review

Resubmissions are subsequent prior authorization requests submitted after the initial prior authorization request was submitted and reviewed and after the WISeR Participant makes a non-affirmed decision. The requester may submit another complete prior authorization request, including all required documentation and needed modifications, as noted in the detailed decision notification. Unlimited resubmissions are permitted. The requester must include the original non-affirmed UTN on the resubmitted prior authorization request.

When resubmitting a request, the requester may request peer-to-peer clinical review to inform the new determination. Under peer-to-peer review, the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier will be connected with a clinician(s) with specialty expertise on the condition under review. The discussion will leverage the applicable NCD or LCD along with the WISeR clinical documentation requirements (see Section 6).

Resubmissions, which could include peer-to-peer review, should be conducted within the standard or expedited time frames specified in Section 4.2.1 or 4.2.2.

### 4.5. Decision Notification

The requester will receive a notification of the prior authorization determination, including the MAC-generated UTN. This notification will be sent in the same format in which the prior authorization request was originally submitted and within the time frames described in Section 4.2 of this guide.

CMS allows physicians or practitioners to submit the prior authorization request on behalf of a facility. Physicians and practitioners who submit the prior authorization request on behalf of a facility should include their contact information on the request cover sheet, in addition to the facility's contact information. If the physician or practitioner is not the requester and would like to obtain a copy of the decision notification, they should contact the facility.

The WISeR Participant will also send a copy of the notification to the WISeR Beneficiary.

## Section 5. Exemption(s)

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CMS and WISeR Participants are implementing a process in 2026 to automatically exempt a WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier from the prior authorization process and pre-payment medical review upon demonstration of compliance with Medicare coverage, coding, and payment rules.

To achieve Exemption Status, a provider must do the following:

1. Submit at least 10 prior authorization requests across WISeR Select Items and Services during an exemption assessment period
2. Achieve a minimum affirmation threshold during an exemption assessment period.

More specifics related to these criteria will be publicly posted by the WISeR Participants in Spring 2026. WISeR Participants will also deliver provider education specific to the Exemption Program. Beginning in June 2026, WISeR Participants will start to issue notifications to WISeR Providers and Suppliers who have been added to the Exemption Status list. WISeR Providers and Suppliers will be added to the Exemption Status list on a quarterly basis. The notification will specify the effective date of Exemption Status and the process for reevaluating Exemption Status.

### 5.1 Reevaluation of Exemption Status

Exempted WISeR Providers and Suppliers will maintain their status for a defined period of time (e.g., at least a year). WISeR Participants will reevaluate Exemption Status through issuing no more than 10 additional documentation requests (ADRs) per year, examining continued compliance with Medicare coverage criteria. After reevaluation is completed, WISeR Participants will notify any providers who lose Exemption Status at least 60 days before the start of the next quarter. The notification will include the effective date of removal and the process for re-earning Exemption Status.

## Section 6. Program Specifics for Selected Items and Services

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### 6.1. Implementation of WISeR Prior Authorization

The WISeR Participants and MACs will begin accepting prior authorization requests for WISeR Select Items and Services starting on January 5, 2026, for services rendered on or after January 15, 2026.

### 6.2. Required Documentation

To meet coverage criteria, the patient's medical record must contain documentation that fully supports the medical necessity of services. Subsections 6.2.1 to 6.2.13 list the documentation requirements for example services.

For detailed documentation requirements, providers who choose to submit a prior authorization request for a WISeR Select Item or Service should refer to the relevant NCDs and/or their MAC jurisdiction's LCDs and Local Coverage Articles (LCAs), if available, for guidance. They can be found on the Medicare Coverage Database website.<sup>8</sup>

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<sup>8</sup> Search the [Medicare Coverage Database](#).



WISeR does not change Medicare coding, coverage, or payment criteria and does not interfere with existing processes to reconsider NCDs or LCDs (e.g., when the Food and Drug Administration label for the use of the device has changed). NCDs and LCDs are periodically updated by CMS and/or the MACs, and WISeR will align with the effective version of the NCD or LCD in place at the time of the prior authorization request and/or pre-payment review.

For WISeR services with NCDs that contain broader criteria, WISeR will initially limit implementation to select indications and HCPCS/CPT codes, which can be expanded in the future.

**Please note that CMS is delaying the implementation of Deep Brain Stimulation (DBS) in WISeR.** As a result, DBS will not be subject to prior authorization or pre-payment review under the WISeR Model when the model began on January 1, 2026. Unlike other WISeR items and services, DBS is commonly delivered as a two-stage procedure, and as of October 2025, the CPT codes for the first stage (e.g., implantation of electrodes, CPT codes 61867 and 61868) are on the Medicare Inpatient Only list. CMS remains committed to excluding services that are delivered solely in the inpatient setting to protect beneficiaries and ensure they receive medically necessary care in the most clinically appropriate setting. CMS will reevaluate implementing prior authorization or pre-payment review of DBS under WISeR in a future model performance year.

**CMS is also delaying the implementation of the Percutaneous Image-Guided Lumbar Decompression for Spinal Stenosis (PILD) in WISeR.** As a result, PILD will not be subject to prior authorization or pre-payment review under the WISeR Model when the model began on January 1, 2026. Unlike other WISeR items and services at this time, PILD has multiple clinical study approvals under its Coverage with Evidence Development (CED) program, which impacts its operational feasibility. CMS will reevaluate implementing prior authorization or pre-payment review of PILD under WISeR in a future model performance year.

The following WISeR services are subject to prior authorization and pre-payment review if performed in a WISeR Jurisdiction. The HCPCS/CPT codes associated with the following selected items and services are listed in Appendix A.

1. Arthroscopic Lavage and Arthroscopic Debridement for the Osteoarthritic Knee (NCD 150.9)
2. Induced Lesions of Nerve Tracts (NCD 160.1)
3. Vagus Nerve Stimulation (NCD 160.18)
4. Phrenic Nerve Stimulators (NCD 160.19)
5. Electrical Nerve Stimulators (NCD 160.7)
6. Incontinence Control Devices (NCD 230.10)
7. Sacral Nerve Stimulators for Urinary Incontinence (NCD 230.18)
8. Diagnosis and Treatment of Impotence (NCD 230.4)
9. Percutaneous Vertebral Augmentation for Vertebral Compression Fracture (L34228, L38201, L35130)
10. Epidural Steroid Injections for Pain Management (L39015, L39240, L36920)
11. Cervical Fusion (L39741, L39758, L39793)
12. Hypoglossal Nerve Stimulation for Obstructive Sleep Apnea (L38307, L38310, L38385)
13. Application of Bioengineered Skin Substitutes to Lower Extremity Chronic Non-Healing Wounds (L35041) and Wound Application of Cellular and/or Tissue Based Products (CTPs), Lower Extremities (L36690)



14. Deep Brain Stimulation (NCD 160.24): implementation delayed and will not occur on January 1, 2026; to be reevaluated for implementation in a future performance year
15. Percutaneous Image-Guided Lumbar Decompression for Spinal Stenosis (NCD 150.13): implementation delayed and will not occur on January 1, 2026; to be reevaluated for implementation in a future performance year

### **6.2.1. Arthroscopic Lavage and Arthroscopic Debridement for the Osteoarthritic Knee (NCD 150.9)**

General documentation requirements for arthroscopic lavage and arthroscopic debridement of the osteoarthritic knee are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation that the patient has less severe and/or early degenerative arthritis and is presenting with symptoms other than pain alone, e.g., mechanical symptoms that include, but are not limited to, catching, locking, snapping, or popping.
- ☐ Documentation to support the patient's knee condition, including but not limited to:
  - a) Reports of standing x-rays
  - b) Magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) results
  - c) Arthroscopy results (in the event of pre-payment review)

### **6.2.2. Induced Lesions of Nerve Tracts (NCD 160.1)**

For this NCD, WISer will initially focus on neurolytic destruction of the trigeminal nerve. General documentation requirements are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of diagnosis and evaluation of trigeminal neuralgia, including history (of compatible clinical features and impact on daily function) and imaging, as applicable
- ☐ Documentation of failure of or intolerance to conventional medications (e.g., carbamazepine, oxcarbazepine, gabapentin)
- ☐ Documentation of the clinical rationale (e.g., patient cannot tolerate open surgery, patient does not have signs of neurovascular compromise) supporting the selection of rhizotomy or neurolysis over other surgical options (e.g., microvascular decompression, stereotactic radiosurgery)

### **6.2.3. Vagus Nerve Stimulation (VNS) (NCD 160.18)<sup>9</sup>**

General documentation requirements for initial implantation<sup>10</sup> of vagus nerve stimulation (VNS) for the treatment of medically refractory partial onset seizures are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of medically refractory partial onset seizures with failure of or intolerance to trial(s) of single or combination antiepileptic therapy
- ☐ Documentation with rationale that the patient is not a candidate for epilepsy surgery, has failed epilepsy surgery, or refuses epilepsy surgery after shared decision-making

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<sup>9</sup> Prior authorization and pre-payment medical review for Vagus Nerve Stimulation will only be implemented for the indications specified in Appendix B.

<sup>10</sup> WISer will initially focus on initial implantation of VNS. Revisions and replacements are out of scope of WISer, but this may be subject to change in the future. As per Section D of NCD 160.18, patients implanted with a VNS device for TRD may receive a VNS device replacement if it is required due to the end of battery life or any other device-related malfunction.

General documentation requirements for initial implantation<sup>11</sup> of VNS for treatment-resistant depression (TRD) through CMS' Coverage with Evidence Development (CED)<sup>12</sup> are as follows:

- ☐ Enrollment in an active CMS-approved trial associated with this NCD/CED
- ☐ Documentation of a major depressive disorder (MDD) episode for at least 2 years or at least four episodes of MDD, including the current episode
- ☐ Documentation of a minimum criterion of four prior failed treatments of adequate dose and duration, as measured by a tool designed for this purpose
- ☐ Documentation of a major depressive episode (MDE) as measured by a guideline-recommended depression scale assessment tool on two visits, within a 45-day span prior to implantation of the VNS device
- ☐ Documentation of a stable medication regimen for at least 4 weeks before device implantation
- ☐ Documentation that none of the following criteria are present:
  - a) Current or lifetime history of psychotic features in any MDE
  - b) Current or lifetime history of schizophrenia or schizoaffective disorder
  - c) Current or lifetime history of any other psychotic disorder
  - d) Current or lifetime history of rapid cycling bipolar disorder
  - e) Current secondary diagnosis of delirium, dementia, amnesia, or other cognitive disorder
  - f) Current suicidal intent
  - g) Treatment with another investigational device or investigational drugs

#### **6.2.4. Phrenic Nerve Stimulator (NCD 160.19)**

For hypoventilation caused by respiratory paralysis resulting from lesions of the brainstem and cervical spinal cord (interruption of neuronal conduction at or above the C3 vertebral level), congenital central hypoventilation syndrome, and other disorders with ventilatory insufficiency (in which there is dependence on intermittent or permanent use of a mechanical ventilation as well as maintenance of a permanent tracheotomy stoma), the general documentation requirements for initial implantation of a phrenic nerve stimulator are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of the etiology of ventilatory insufficiency as well as evaluation (e.g., of diaphragmatic function) and management to date, including the use of mechanical ventilation
- ☐ Documentation of intact phrenic nerve and diaphragmatic function, e.g., through a percutaneous nerve conduction study
- ☐ Documentation of absence of severe underlying primary pulmonary disease through history and exam, prior and current chest imaging, and pulmonary function testing (when feasible)

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<sup>11</sup> WISer will initially focus on initial implantation of VNS. Revisions and replacements are out of scope of WISer, but this may be subject to change in the future. As per Section D of NCD 160.18, patients implanted with a VNS device for TRD may receive a VNS device replacement if it is required due to the end of battery life or any other device-related malfunction.

<sup>12</sup> Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services. (2024). [Vagus nerve stimulation \(VNS\) for treatment resistant depression \(TRD\)](#).

For central sleep apnea (CSA), the general documentation requirements for initial implantation of a phrenic nerve stimulator are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of etiology of CSA as idiopathic/primary or heart-failure–related CSA (not opioid- or medication-induced)
- ☐ Documentation of moderate to severe CSA confirmed by polysomnography
- ☐ Documentation of failure of, intolerance of, or contraindication to at least one of the following:
  - a) Continuous positive airway pressure (CPAP)
  - b) Bilevel positive airway pressure (BiPAP)
  - c) Adaptive servo-ventilation (ASV)
  - d) Nocturnal oxygen (for patients who have hypoxemia while sleeping)
- ☐ For patients with heart failure (HF): documentation of New York Heart Association (NYHA) class, left ventricular ejection fraction (LVEF), and stable, optimized guideline-directed medical therapy (GDMT) as applicable
- ☐ Documentation of plan for device interaction testing if patient has an implantable cardioverter-defibrillator (ICD), cardiac resynchronization therapy (CRT), or pacemaker
- ☐ Assessment and documentation of none of the following contraindications:
  - a) Active infection
  - b) NYHA IV HF or American College of Cardiology (ACC)/American Heart Association (AHA) Stage D
  - c) Recent stroke/transient ischemic attack (TIA)
  - d) Currently on renal dialysis or severe renal disease
  - e) Phrenic nerve palsy or other anatomic barriers
  - f) Opioid or other medication-induced CSA

### **6.2.5. Electrical Nerve Stimulators (NCD 160.7)**

For this NCD, WISer will initially focus on spinal cord stimulators but will not overlap with or include CPT code 63650 for percutaneous implantation of spinal neurostimulators in CMS' Prior Authorization Program for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department (OPD) Services.<sup>13</sup>

Prior authorization and pre-payment review are being implemented for the permanent implantation procedure. A trial procedure should be done, and documentation should be submitted for permanent implantation of a stimulator device.

General documentation requirements for laminectomy for the implantation of a spinal cord stimulator for the relief of chronic intractable pain are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of condition requiring procedure and applicable physical exam
- ☐ Documentation that stimulation is being used only as a late resort (if not a last resort) for patients with chronic intractable pain, including but not limited to at least one treatment tried and failed (or documentation that they were contraindicated):
  - a) Medications

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<sup>13</sup> CPT code 63650 for implanted spinal stimulator is included in CMS' Prior Authorization Program for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services. For more information, please visit the [Prior Authorization for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services webpage](#).

- b) Physical therapy
- c) Injections
- d) Spine surgery
- e) Cognitive behavioral therapy
- ☐ Documentation showing that the patient was evaluated by a multidisciplinary team (including psychological,<sup>14</sup> surgical, medical, and physical therapy)
- ☐ Documentation showing that the patient achieved demonstrated 50% reduction in pain relief and evidence of functional restoration with a temporarily implanted electrode
- ☐ Documentation that the patient is not a candidate for percutaneously placed leads (e.g., previous instrumentation, challenging anatomy, high body mass index (BMI), other technical challenges), as WISeR does not include CPT 63650 for the trial or permanent implantation of spinal neurostimulators via the percutaneous approach.<sup>15</sup>

### **6.2.6. Incontinence Control Devices (NCD 230.10)**

NCD 230.10 provides Medicare coverage and payment criteria for the use of mechanical/hydraulic incontinence control devices and collagen implants or injections. Given urethral bulking agents no longer contain collagen (as Contigen® has been discontinued), WISeR initially will focus on mechanical/hydraulic incontinence control devices for the purposes of treating Stress Urinary Incontinence (SUI).

General documentation requirements for mechanical/hydraulic incontinence control devices are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of evaluation and diagnosis of SUI, such as but not limited to:
  - a) Relevant history, in particular, elements that may impact placement of an incontinence control device such as prior prostate or pelvic surgery, pelvic radiation therapy, or urethral trauma (resulting in damage to the urethral sphincter), if applicable
  - b) Physical examination, including pelvic or rectal exam, if applicable
  - c) Urinalysis: Patients with an abnormal urinalysis, such as unexplained hematuria or pyuria, should undergo additional evaluation if being considered for surgical intervention.
  - d) Result of a cough or bladder stress test or an objective demonstration of urinary incontinence with a comfortably full bladder
  - e) Additional testing, if applicable
    - Voiding diary (at least 24 hours of symptoms)
    - Cystoscopy where there is a concern for urinary tract abnormalities
    - Urodynamic testing for complicated or mixed symptoms (e.g., patients with mixed incontinence in whom the predominant contributor is unclear)

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<sup>14</sup> See Medicare Learning Network (MLN1986542) booklet and Publication #100-2, Chapter 15, for more information on psychological evaluations.

<sup>15</sup> CPT code 63650 for implanted spinal stimulator is included in CMS' Prior Authorization Program for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services. For more information, please visit the [Prior Authorization for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services webpage](#).

- f) Assessment and exclusion of other etiologies of urinary incontinence (e.g., known or suspected urinary tract infection, high post-void residual volume concerning for overflow incontinence, high-grade pelvic organ prolapse if SUI is not demonstrated by pelvic organ prolapse reduction)
- ☐ Documentation of adjunctive measures and treatments tried and failed (or contraindicated), such as but not limited to:
  - a) Lifestyle modifications (e.g., addressing contributory medical conditions, limiting alcohol and caffeine consumption, weight reduction if overweight, modifying fluid intake)
  - b) Pelvic floor muscle training ( $\pm$  biofeedback)
  - c) Low-dose vaginal estrogen for patients with genitourinary syndrome of menopause (GSM) or evidence of hypoestrogenism by history or exam
  - d) Support devices (e.g., continence pessaries, vaginal inserts, penile clamps)
  - e) Prior surgery for SUI
- ☐ Documentation for any planned concomitant procedures that may affect outcomes associated with placement of an incontinence control device (e.g., patients should not undergo concomitant urethral diverticulectomy, repair of urethrovaginal fistula, or urethral mesh excision and stress incontinence surgery with the exception of placement of autologous slings)

#### **6.2.7. Sacral Nerve Stimulation for Urinary Incontinence (NCD 230.18)<sup>16</sup>**

Prior authorization and pre-payment review are being implemented for the permanent implantation procedure. A trial procedure should be done, and documentation should be submitted for permanent implantation of a stimulator device.<sup>17</sup> Please note that lead replacement billed under CPT code 64561 does not require prior authorization or pre-payment review under WISer, as NCD 230.18 does not explicitly address replacements.

General documentation requirements for a permanently implanted sacral nerve stimulator for the treatment of urinary urge incontinence, urgency-frequency syndrome, or urinary retention are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of the relevant diagnosis (e.g., urge incontinence, urgency-frequency syndrome, or urinary retention)
  - a) Of note, urinary voiding dysfunction should not be a secondary manifestation of specific neurologic diseases (e.g., diabetes with peripheral nerve involvement), stress incontinence, or urinary (e.g., bladder outlet) obstruction.
- ☐ Documentation of treatments tried and failed (or contraindications), such as but not limited to:
  - a) Behavioral therapy (e.g., bladder training, pelvic floor rehabilitation)
  - b) Pharmacologic therapy
  - c) Surgical corrective therapy (e.g., augmentation cystoplasty)

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<sup>16</sup> Prior authorization and pre-payment medical review for Sacral Nerve Stimulation for Urinary Incontinence will only be implemented for the indications specified in Appendix C.

<sup>17</sup> During pre-payment review, the billing of a generator implantation code (CPT code 64590) will be used to differentiate between a trial and permanent implantation (billed using CPT code 64561).

- ☐ Documentation that the patient is capable of demonstrating adequate ability to record voiding diary data such that the clinical results of the implant procedure can be properly evaluated
- ☐ Documentation that the patient had a successful test stimulation, as demonstrated by 50% or greater improvement (as measured through voiding diaries)

### **6.2.8. Diagnosis and Treatment of Impotence (NCD 230.4)**

NCD 230.4 provides Medicare coverage and payment criteria for the diagnosis and treatment of impotence. WISer initially will implement prior authorization for the insertion of penile prostheses (CPT codes 54400, 54401, and 54405). General documentation requirements are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of evaluation and diagnosis of erectile dysfunction (e.g., testosterone level if a patient has signs or symptoms concerning for hypogonadism)
- ☐ Treatments tried and failed (or contraindicated), such as but not limited to addressing reversible etiologies:
  - a) Oral medications, e.g., phosphodiesterase-5 (PDE-5) inhibitors
  - b) Intracavernosal injection
  - c) Vacuum-assisted erection device
  - d) Psychotherapy (for psychogenic erectile dysfunction)
  - e) Testosterone replacement therapy (for patients with testosterone deficiency)
- ☐ Absence of systemic infection, active urogenital infection, and/or active skin infection in the region of surgery

### **6.2.9. Percutaneous Vertebral Augmentation (PVA) for Vertebral Compression Fracture (VCF) (L34228, L38201, L35130)**

General documentation requirements for Percutaneous Vertebroplasty Augmentation (PVA) (Percutaneous Vertebroplasty [PVP] or Kyphoplasty [PKP]) are as follows:

- ☐ For painful, debilitating, osteoporotic, vertebral, collapse/compression fractures, the following requirements should be met:
  - a) Acute (less than 6 weeks) or subacute (6 to 12 weeks) osteoporotic VCF (T1–L5) based on symptom onset and documented by advanced imaging (bone marrow edema on MRI or bone-scan/single-photon emission computed tomography (SPECT)/computed tomography (CT) uptake)
  - b) Hospitalized with severe pain, defined as a Numeric Rating Scale (NRS) or Visual Analog Scale (VAS) pain score greater than or equal to 8 **OR** non-hospitalized with moderate to severe pain, defined as a NRS or VAS pain score greater than or equal to 5, despite optimal non-surgical management (e.g., narcotic and/or non-narcotic medication, physical therapy modalities), with and without methods of immobility (e.g., rest, bracing). For non-hospitalized patients, one of the following must be documented:
    - Worsening pain **OR**
    - Stable to improved pain (but NRS or VAS score remains greater than or equal to 5), with at least 2 of the following:
      1. Progression of vertebral body height loss
      2. More than 25% vertebral body height reduction
      3. Kyphotic deformity

- 4. Severe impact of VCF on daily functioning, indicated by a Roland Morris Disability Questionnaire (RDQ) score greater than 17
- c) Documentation of referral for evaluation of bone mineral density and osteoporosis education for subsequent treatment as indicated
- d) Documentation of instruction to participate in an osteoporosis prevention/treatment program
- ☐ For malignant vertebral fracture, documentation that the patient has an osteolytic vertebral, metastasis, or myeloma with severe back pain related to a destruction of the vertebral body, not involving the major part of the cortical bone
- ☐ Assessment and documentation of none of the following:
  - a) Current back pain is *not* primarily due to the identified acute or subacute VCF(s)
  - b) Osteomyelitis, discitis, or active systemic or surgical site infection
  - c) Pregnancy
- ☐ Assessment of the following relative contraindications and rationale for proceeding with PVA if one or more of the following exist:
  - a) Greater than three vertebral fractures per procedure
  - b) Allergy to bone cement or opacification agents
  - c) Uncorrected coagulopathy
  - d) Spinal instability
  - e) Myelopathy from the fracture
  - f) Neurologic deficit
  - g) Neural impingement
  - h) Fracture retropulsion/canal compromise

#### **6.2.10. Epidural Steroid Injections for Pain Management (L39015, L39240, L36920)<sup>18</sup>**

Prior authorization and pre-payment review are being implemented for CPT code 62323 only when used for Epidural Steroid Injections (ESI). Please note that CPT code 62323 does not require prior authorization or pre-payment review under WISer when submitted for indications other than specified in the selected LCDs, including but not limited to implantation of an intrathecal pump for treatment of pain or spasticity.

General documentation requirements for ESI for pain management are as follows:

- ☐ Documentation of history, physical examination, and radiological testing demonstrating one of the following:
  - a) Lumbar, cervical, or thoracic radiculopathy; radicular pain and/or neurogenic claudication due to disc herniation; osteophyte or osteophyte complexes; severe degenerative disc disease, producing foraminal or central spinal stenosis; **OR**
  - b) Post-laminectomy syndrome (persistent or recurrent spinal pain after a prior spine surgery); **OR**
  - c) Acute herpes zoster–associated pain; **AND**
- ☐ Documentation that radiculopathy, radicular pain, and/or neurogenic claudication is severe enough to greatly impact quality of life or function, including documentation that an objective

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<sup>18</sup> Please reference the associated LCD Reference Articles for the selected LCDs for more information about ICD-10 codes that support medical necessity for this service as defined by the MAC.



pain scale or functional assessment was performed at baseline (prior to interventions) and that the same scale was repeated at each follow-up for assessment of response; AND

- ☐ Documentation of pain duration of at least 4 weeks and the inability to tolerate noninvasive conservative care **OR** medical documentation of failure to respond to 4 weeks of noninvasive conservative care **OR** acute herpes zoster refractory to conservative management where a 4-week wait is not required
- ☐ Documentation of anticipated number of ESI sessions (four or less) per spinal region in a rolling 12-month period. For repeat sessions, documentation of at least 50% sustained improvement in pain or function from baseline on the same scale for at least 3 months
  - Of note, if the first ESI underperforms, a repeat session after 14 days may be done with a different approach/level/medication and a clear rationale
- ☐ If applicable: In exceptional and unique cases, documentation establishing the patient-specific need for moderate or deep sedation, general anesthesia, or monitored anesthesia care, as these are generally not required for the procedure.
- ☐ Documentation of the type of image guidance (fluoroscopy or CT with contrast) to be used. If the patient has a documented contrast allergy or pregnancy, ultrasound guidance without contrast may be considered.
- ☐ Documentation of the planned approach, including targeted level(s) and region(s)
  - Of note, transforaminal ESIs (TFESIs) up to two levels in one spinal region; interlaminar ESIs or caudal ESIs up to one level in one spinal region; and bilateral TFESI only when clinically indicated (e.g., documented bilateral foraminal stenosis or central herniation affecting both roots) are considered medically reasonable and necessary.
- ☐ Documentation that the ESI is performed in conjunction with conservative treatments, such as but not limited to:
  - Medication
  - Physical therapy
  - Spinal manipulation therapy
  - Cognitive behavioral therapy
  - Home exercise program
- ☐ Documentation that the patient is part of an active rehabilitation program, home exercise program, or functional restoration program
- ☐ Assessment and documentation of none of the following contraindications:
  - Active localized spinal infection or systemic infection
  - Compressive lesions of the spinal cord
  - Conus medullaris or cauda equina



### 6.2.11. Cervical Fusion (L39741, L39758, L39793)

Select cervical fusion procedure codes are included in CMS' Prior Authorization Program for Certain Hospital OPD Services.<sup>19</sup> WISer will initially focus on CPT code 22554, which is not included in CMS' Hospital OPD program.

General documentation requirements for cervical fusion for the decompression or stabilization of the cervical spine are as follows:

- ☐ For traumatic injuries, including fractures, dislocations, fracture-dislocations, or traumatic ligamentous disruption, documentation of:
  - a) Fractures or dislocations that are likely to result in spinal instability without neurological defects; **OR**
  - b) Fractures or dislocations associated with neurological defects at the affected level; **OR**
  - c) Presence of instability
- ☐ For spinal tumors involving the spine or spinal canal, documentation of:
  - a) Malignant or benign tumors that have caused instability or neurologic deficit where treatment of the tumor will likely require stabilization of the spine; **OR**
  - b) Expected treatment of the tumor, whether by chemotherapy or radiation therapy or surgery, will likely cause spinal instability or neurologic deficits; **OR**
  - c) Presence of instability
- ☐ For infection involving the spine in the form of discitis, osteomyelitis, or epidural abscess, documentation of:
  - a) Imaging or other studies (MRI, biopsy, bone aspirate) demonstrating infection **AND**
  - b) Imaging evidence of vertebral body destruction *or* documentation that spinal debridement will cause vertebral instability; **OR**
  - c) Presence of instability
- ☐ For deformities that include the cervical spine, documentation of:
  - a) Cervical kyphosis associated with cord compression or atlantoaxial (C1–C2) subluxation or basilar invagination of the odontoid process into the foramen magnum; *or* subaxial (C2–T1) instability kyphosis, head drop syndrome, post-laminectomy deformity; **OR**
  - b) Symptomatic pseudarthrosis (non-union of prior fusion) with radiological (e.g., CT or MRI) demonstration of non-union of prior fusion (lack of bridging bone or abnormal motion at fused segment) after 12 months since fusion surgery *or* with radiographic evidence of hardware failure (fracture or displacement); **OR**
  - c) Spinal instability after laminectomy; **OR**
  - d) Rheumatoid arthritis with associated instability; **OR**
  - e) Cervical degenerative spondylolisthesis with spinal instability (anterolisthesis/posterolisthesis) **AND**
  - f) Presence of substantial functional limitation, such as severe neck pain or difficulty ambulating or decreased ability to perform Activities of Daily Living or ability to maintain forward gaze **OR**
  - g) Progression of deformity

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<sup>19</sup> CPT codes 22551 and 22552 for cervical fusion are included in CMS' Prior Authorization Program for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services. For more information, please visit the [Prior Authorization for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services webpage](#).

### **6.2.12. Hypoglossal Nerve Stimulation (HGNS) for Obstructive Sleep Apnea (L38307, L38310, L38385)<sup>20</sup>**

General documentation requirements for the implantation of a hypoglossal nerve stimulator for obstructive sleep apnea are as follows — the following requirements should be met:

- ☐ Age 22 or older
- ☐ BMI is less than 35 kg/m<sup>2</sup>
- ☐ Results of polysomnography performed within 24 months of first consultation of HGNS implant (include date of first consultation of HGNS implant and date of polysomnography test) showing:
  - a) Predominantly obstructive events (defined as central and mixed apneas less than 25% of the total apnea-hypopnea index [AHI]) **AND**
  - b) AHI is 15 to 65 events per hour
- ☐ Documentation demonstrating one of the following:
  - Continuous positive airway pressure (CPAP) failure (defined as AHI greater than 15 events per hour, despite CPAP usage) **OR**
  - CPAP intolerance (defined as less than 4 hours per night, 5 nights per week, or CPAP has been returned), including shared decision-making that the patient was intolerant of CPAP despite consultation with a sleep expert
- ☐ Drug-induced sleep endoscopy (DISE) procedure showing absence of complete concentric collapse at the soft palate level
- ☐ Documentation of any other anatomical findings that would compromise performance of device, e.g., tonsil size 4 per standardized tonsillar hypertrophy grading scale, laryngeal abnormalities that would cause a fixed obstruction (e.g., supraglottic stenosis, post-radiation fibrosis, laryngoceles, anterior cervical osteophytes impinging or pushing on the posterior pharynx)
- ☐ Documentation of counseling regarding future MRI utilization (depending on model implanted)
- ☐ Assessment and documentation of none of the following contraindications:
  - a) Central and mixed apneas compromising more than one-quarter of the total AHI
  - b) Another implantable device that could result in an unintended interaction with the HGNS implant system (e.g., pacemakers, implantable cardioverter-defibrillators, other nerve stimulators)
  - c) BMI equal to or greater than 35 kg/m<sup>2</sup>
  - d) Neuromuscular disease
  - e) Hypoglossal-nerve palsy
  - f) Severe restrictive or obstructive pulmonary disease
  - g) Moderate-to-severe pulmonary arterial hypertension
  - h) Severe valvular heart disease

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<sup>20</sup> Prior authorization and pre-payment medical review for HGNS will be implemented for the primary codes specified in Appendix A. As published in the [MLN Connects® Newsletter](#) on January 22, 2026, WISer does not include CPT 64568 billed with ICD-10 code G47.33 (obstructive sleep apnea). Providers with questions about billing for HGNS should contact their respective MAC.

- i) New York Heart Association class III or IV heart failure
- j) Recent myocardial infarction or severe cardiac arrhythmias (within the past 6 months)
- k) Persistent uncontrolled hypertension despite medication use
- l) An active, serious mental illness that reduces the ability to carry out Activities of Daily Living and would interfere with the patient's ability to operate the HGNS device and report problems to the attending provider
- m) Coexisting non-respiratory sleep disorders that would confound functional sleep assessment
- n) Patient is or plans to become pregnant
- o) Patient is unable or does not have the necessary assistance to operate the sleep remote
- p) Patient has a condition or procedure that has compromised neurological control of the upper airway

### **6.2.13. Application of Bioengineered Skin Substitutes to Lower Extremity Chronic Non-Healing Wounds (L35041) and Wound Application of CTPs, Lower Extremities (L36690)<sup>21 22</sup>**

General documentation requirements for the application of a skin substitute or cellular and/or tissue product (CTP) in the treatment of diabetic foot ulcer(s) (DFU) and venous leg ulcer(s) (VLU) are as follows:

- ☐ Description of the wound or ulcer at baseline (prior to beginning standard of care [SOC] treatment) relative to size, location, stage, duration, and presence of infection, as well as progression throughout treatments tried
- ☐ Documentation of the following related to the wound or ulcer:
  - a) Partial- or full-thickness ulcers, not involving tendon, muscle, or joint capsule or exhibiting exposed bone or sinus tracts, have a clean granular base unless the CTP package label indicates the CTP is approved for use involving tendon, muscle, or joint capsule or exhibiting exposed bone or sinus tracts, with a clean granular base
  - b) Skin deficit at least 1.0 square cm in size
  - c) Clean and free of necrotic debris or exudate
  - d) Adequate circulation/oxygenation to support tissue growth/wound healing, as evidenced by physical examination (e.g., Ankle-Brachial Index [ABI] of no less than 0.60, toe pressure >30 mmHg)
  - e) For DFUs, a diagnosis of Type 1 or Type 2 diabetes along with medical management for this condition
- ☐ Documentation addressing the circumstances why the wound or ulcer has had a "failed response," defined as having failed to respond to documented appropriate wound-care measures, having increased in size or depth, or having not changed in baseline size or depth

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<sup>21</sup> Prior authorization and pre-payment medical review will be implemented if it meets the requirements for the codes in Appendix A and ICD-10 diagnosis code for diabetic and venous leg ulcers specified in Appendix B.

<sup>22</sup> Skin substitutes are currently not subject to prior authorization under WISeR for providers in MAC jurisdiction JF. WISeR participants must adhere to the NCDs and LCDs that are currently active in their respective state, participants in MAC jurisdiction JF (Noridian) will not proceed with prior authorization and/or prepayment review of skin substitutes as the LCD has been withdrawn. This change does not impact LCDs for skin substitutes already in effect before January 1, 2026.

with no indication that improvement is likely (such as granulation, epithelialization, or progress toward closing), including but not limited to:

- a) Interventions that failed
  - b) Updated medication history
  - c) Review of pertinent medical problems that may have occurred since previous wound or ulcer evaluations
  - d) For a neuropathic DFU, documentation of failure to respond to conservative wound-care measures of greater than 4 weeks, during which the patient is compliant with recommendations, and without evidence of underlying osteomyelitis or nidus of infection
  - e) For a venous stasis ulcer present for at least 3 months, documentation of failure to respond to appropriate wound care for at least 30 days with documented compliance
  - f) For a full-thickness skin loss ulcer that is the result of abscess, injury, or trauma, documentation of failure to respond to appropriate control of infection, foreign body, tumor resection, or other disease process for a period of 4 weeks or longer
- ☐ Documentation that therapy has resolved any infection and/or underlying osteomyelitis with documentation of the conditions that have been treated and resolved, as applicable:
- a) Control of edema, venous hypertension, or lymphedema
  - b) Control of any nidus of infection or colonization with bacterial or fungal elements
  - c) Elimination of underlying cellulitis, osteomyelitis, foreign body, or malignant process
  - d) Appropriate debridement of necrotic tissue or foreign body (exposed bone or tendon)
  - e) For DFUs, appropriate non-weight-bearing or off-loading pressure
  - f) For venous stasis ulcers, compression therapy provided with documented diligent use of multilayer dressings, compression stockings of greater than 20 mmHg pressure, or pneumatic compression
  - g) Provision of wound environment to promote healing (protection from trauma and contaminants, elimination of inciting or aggravating processes)
- ☐ Documentation of smoking history and that the patient has received counseling on the effects of smoking on outcomes and treatment for smoking cessation (if applicable)
- ☐ Documentation of choice of skin substitute graft product
- ☐ Documentation of expected number of applications over a 12-week period. Of note, simultaneous use of more than one product for the episode of wound is not covered. Product change within the episode of wound is allowed, not to exceed the 10-application limit per wound per 12-week period of care
- ☐ Assessment and documentation of none of the following:
- a) Partial thickness loss with the retention of epithelial appendages is not a candidate for grafting or replacement, as epithelium will repopulate the deficit from the appendages, negating the benefit of overgrafting
  - b) Prior utilization of skin substitute grafts when a previous full course of applications was unsuccessful within 1 year. Unsuccessful treatment is defined as:
    - Increase in size or depth of an ulcer or no change in baseline size or depth **AND**
    - No sign of improvement or indication that improvement is likely (such as granulation, epithelialization, or progress toward closing) for a period of 4 weeks past start of therapy

- c) Retreatment of healed ulcers (those showing greater than 75% size reduction and smaller than 0.5 square cm)
- d) Patient has inadequate control of underlying conditions or exacerbating factors (e.g., uncontrolled diabetes, active infection, active Charcot arthropathy of the ulcer extremity, vasculitis, or continued tobacco smoking without physician attempt to address smoking cessation)
- e) Known hypersensitivity to any component of the specific skin substitute graft (e.g., allergy to avian, bovine, porcine, equine products)

## Section 7. Claim Submission

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Please note that for services rendered in the Hospital OPD or ASC settings, the UTN should be submitted with the facility-based claim.

### 7.1. General Claims Submission Requirements

When a prior authorization request was submitted and a provisional affirmation or non-affirmation prior authorization decision was granted for an institutional claim processed through the Fiscal Intermediary Shared System (FISS) (e.g., facility-based claims from the Hospital OPD setting), the following requirements apply:

- The submission of the prior authorized claim is to have the 14-byte UTN that is located on the decision notification. For submission of electronic claims, the UTN must be in positions 1 through 18. When the claim enters the FISS, the UTN will move to positions 19 through 32, and zeros will autofill the first field. For requesters submitting electronic claims, the Medicare Treatment Authorization field must contain blanks or valid Medicare data in the first 14 bytes of the Treatment Authorization field at the loop 2300 REF02 (REF01=G1) segment for the ASC X12 837 claim.
- For all other submissions, the requester must tab to the second field of the Treatment Authorization field (positions 19–32) and key the UTN. If information is entered into the first field (positions 1–18), it will come into FISS as zeros. If the Treatment Authorization Code is entered into the first field, FISS will change the code to zeros, and the claim will not be accepted. If the UTN is entered into the first Treatment Authorization field, FISS will change the UTN to all zeros. The claim is accepted into FISS with the zeros and without the UTN. The claim will process without the UTN but will be edited for the UTN.
- Claims must include no more than one UTN and should be submitted to the applicable MAC for adjudication.

When a prior authorization request was submitted and a provisional affirmation or non-affirmation prior authorization decision was granted for a professional claim processed through the Multi-Carrier System, the following requirements apply:

- When submitting an electronic 837 professional claim for a prior authorized service, the UTN must be submitted in the 2300 Claim Information loop in the prior authorization reference (REF) segment where REF01 = “G1” qualifier and REF02 = UTN. A UTN submitted in this loop applies to the entire claim unless it is overridden in the REF segment in the 2400 Service Line loop. This is in accordance with the requirements of the ASC X12 837 Technical Report 3 (TR3).

- When submitting a paper CMS 1500 Claim form for a prior authorized service, the UTN must populate the first 14 positions in item 23. All other data submitted in item 23 must begin in position 15.
- Claims should be submitted to the applicable MAC for adjudication.

### ***7.1.1. Claims Submitted With an Affirmed Prior Authorization Decision on File***

If all Medicare coverage, coding, and payment requirements are met, the claim will likely be paid. However, claims submitted with a provisional affirmation may be denied based on either of the following:

- Technical requirements that can only be evaluated after the claim has been submitted for formal processing
- New information becoming available that was not present at the time of the prior authorization request that would otherwise have caused a non-affirmation decision

Claims for which there is a provisional affirmation prior authorization decision on file will be afforded some protection from future audits, both pre- and post-payment; however, review contractors may audit claims if potential fraud, inappropriate utilization, or changes in billing patterns are identified.

### ***7.1.2. Claims Submitted With a Non-Affirmed Prior Authorization Decision on File***

If the claim is submitted to the MAC for payment with a non-affirmative prior authorization decision on file, it will be denied. All appeal rights would then be available. This claim could then be submitted to secondary insurance, if applicable.

## **7.2. Pre-Payment Medical Review for Claims Submitted Without a Prior Authorization Decision on File**

Submitting prior authorization requests for WISeR Select Items and Services is voluntary; however, if a claim for a WISeR Select Item or Service is submitted without a prior authorization request decision on file, the MAC will suspend the related claim and re-route it to the WISeR Participant to conduct pre-payment medical review. Note that requesters do not need to do anything different when submitting a claim for a WISeR Select Item or Service without a prior authorization decision or UTN on file. They do not need to put any information in the remarks field or submit any unsolicited documentation at the time of claim submission.

Under pre-payment review, the WISeR Participant will contact the billing WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier for medical record documentation to support the claim. The billing WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier will have 45 days to respond to the ADR. For OPDs and ASCs, the ADR will be sent to the billing facility, rather than the physician or practitioner who may have submitted the prior authorization request on behalf of the OPD or ASC.

Following receipt of all medical record information, the WISeR Participant will leverage enhanced technology and clinicians, as applicable, to verify the intended use of the WISeR Select Item or Service, the medical necessity, and alignment with Medicare coverage policies and clinical documentation requirements.

The WISeR Participant will issue a decision to the MAC within 3 days following receipt of all requested documentation. The MAC will then pay or deny the claim based on the pre-payment medical review decision.

Please note that if the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier does not respond to the ADR within 45 days, the MAC will be notified by the WISeR Participant and will deny the related claim.

### 7.3. Payment for Associated Items Services

Claims related to or associated with a WISeR Select Item or Service will not be paid if the WISeR Select Item or Service is non-affirmed during prior authorization or denied payment during claims processing. Associated items and services include anesthesiology services involved during the procedure, devices implanted during implantation surgery, physician services, and/or facility services. Depending on the timing of claim submission for any associated items and services, claims may be automatically denied or denied on a post-payment basis.

Although associated items and services do not undergo prior authorization, these items and services will be approved during claim review if either of the following describes the primary service:

- Submitted for prior authorization and affirmed
- Not submitted for prior authorization, but the claim was approved

Associated items and services will be denied if either of the following describes the primary service:

- Submitted for prior authorization and non-affirmed
- Not submitted for prior authorization, but the claim was denied

The codes for associated items and services are listed in Appendix C. This list is subject to change.

## Section 8. Special Claim Considerations

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### 8.1. Advance Beneficiary Notice of Non-Coverage (ABN)

If the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier receives a non-affirmed prior authorization decision because the service was determined to be not medically reasonable and necessary, the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier should issue an Advance Beneficiary Notice of Non-Coverage (ABN) in advance of performing the service if payment is expected to be denied. The WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier should submit the claim with the GA modifier appended to it. The MAC will determine the validity of the ABN in accordance with standard ABN policies. (See CMS' Internet-Only Manual (IOM) 100-04, Chapter 30.)<sup>23</sup>

If an applicable claim is submitted without a prior authorization decision and is flagged as having an ABN, it will be stopped to request additional documentation, and a review of the ABN will be performed (to determine the validity of the ABN) following standard claim review guidelines and timelines.

The WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier should issue an ABN and submit the claim with a GX modifier if it is expected that Medicare will deny payment for a service under the statutory exclusion for purely

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<sup>23</sup> CMS. (2024). [Chapter 30 - Financial liability protections. In Medicare Claims Processing Manual.](#)



cosmetic services. Under those circumstances, an ABN is voluntary and is not required to bill the WISeR Beneficiary for the service that is denied under the cosmetic services exclusion. However, CMS encourages WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers to issue an ABN in this situation to inform the WISeR Beneficiary of the likelihood of financial liability.

## 8.2. Claims Exclusions

The following claim types are excluded from the WISeR prior authorization process and pre-payment medical review described in this guide, unless otherwise specified:

- Veterans Affairs
- Indian Health Services
- Medicare Advantage
- Medicare Advantage sub-category Indirect Medical Education (IME)-only claims
- Part A and Part B rebilling
- Claims for emergency department services when the claim is submitted with an ET modifier or 045x revenue code (This does not exclude these claims from regular medical review.)

## Section 9. Secondary Insurance

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This section addresses instances when the WISeR Beneficiary has more than one insurance. In these instances, Medicare must be either the primary or secondary insurance company.

### 9.1. Medicare as the Primary Insurance

When Medicare is primary and another insurance company is secondary:

- The MAC will suspend claims to request documentation and conduct a review of the ABN when there is no prior authorization request and the claim is submitted with the GA modifier appended.
- The Contractor will determine the validity of the ABN in accordance with standard ABN policies. (See IOM 100-04, Chapter 30, Section 40).<sup>24</sup>

WISeR Providers and WISeR Suppliers who choose to use the prior authorization process to obtain a claim denial should use the following process:

- The requester may submit the prior authorization request with complete documentation as appropriate. If all relevant Medicare coverage requirements are not met for the service, a non-affirmative prior authorization decision will be sent to the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier and WISeR Beneficiary, advising that Medicare will not pay for the item.
- After the requester receives a non-affirmative decision for the prior authorization request, if the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier submits the associated claim to the MAC for payment, it will be denied.

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<sup>24</sup> CMS. (2024). [Chapter 30 - Financial liability protections. In Medicare Claims Processing Manual.](#)



- The WISeR Provider, WISeR Supplier, or WISeR Beneficiary may forward the denied claim to the WISeR Beneficiary's secondary insurance payer as appropriate to determine payment for the service.

When a WISeR Beneficiary is dually eligible for Medicaid and Medicare, a non-affirmed prior authorization decision is sufficient for meeting states' obligation to pursue other coverage before considering Medicaid coverage. The WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier may need to submit the claim to Medicare first and obtain a denial before submitting the claim to Medicaid for payment.

## 9.2. Medicare as the Secondary Insurance

When another insurance company is primary and Medicare is secondary:

- The requester submits the prior authorization request with complete documentation as appropriate. If all relevant Medicare coverage requirements are met for the item(s), the WISeR Participant will send a provisional affirmative prior authorization decision to the WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier and to the WISeR Beneficiary, if specifically requested by the WISeR Beneficiary, advising them that Medicare will pay for the service.
- The WISeR Provider or WISeR Supplier submits a claim to the other insurance company.
- If the other insurance company denies the claim, the WISeR Provider, WISeR Supplier, or WISeR Beneficiary can submit a claim to the MAC for payment (listing the UTN on the claim).

## Section 10. Claim Appeals

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Claims subject to prior authorization or pre-payment medical review requirements under the WISeR Model will follow all current appeals procedures. A prior authorization request that is non-affirmed is not an initial determination on a claim for payment for services provided and, therefore, would not be appealable; however, the requester has an unlimited number of opportunities to resubmit a prior authorization request, provided the claim has not yet been submitted and denied.

A non-affirmation prior authorization decision does not prevent the provider from submitting a claim. Submission of such a claim and the MAC's resulting denial would constitute an initial payment determination, which would make the appeal rights available.

For further information, please consult the Medicare Claims Processing Manual, Chapter 29, Appeals of Claims Decision.<sup>25</sup>

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<sup>25</sup> CMS. (2023). [Chapter 29 - Appeals of claims decisions. In Medicare Claims Processing Manual.](#)

## Appendices

### Appendix A. WISeR Select Items and Services as of April 24, 2026<sup>26</sup>

The following Current Procedural Terminology (CPT) and Healthcare Common Procedure Coding System (HCPCS) codes,<sup>27</sup> organized by service category and shown in Tables A1 to A13, are subject to prior authorization or pre-payment medical review under the WISeR Model.

**Table A1. Arthroscopic Lavage and Arthroscopic Debridement for the Osteoarthritic Knee (NCD 150.9)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                        |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 29877 | Arthroscopy, knee, surgical; debridement/shaving of articular cartilage (chondroplasty) |

**Table A2. Induced Lesions of Nerve Tracts (NCD 160.1)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                                                                   |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 64605 | Destruction by neurolytic agent, trigeminal nerve; second and third division branches at foramen ovale                             |
| 64610 | Destruction by neurolytic agent, trigeminal nerve; second and third division branches at foramen ovale under radiologic monitoring |

**Table A3. Vagus Nerve Stimulation (NCD 160.18)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                                           |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 64568 | Open implantation of cranial nerve (e.g., vagus nerve) neurostimulator electrode array and pulse generator |

Note: Prior authorization and pre-payment medical review for vagus nerve stimulation will only be implemented for the indications specified in Appendix B.

**Table A4. Phrenic Nerve Stimulator (NCD 160.19)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 33276 | Insertion of phrenic nerve stimulator system (pulse generator and stimulating lead[s]), including vessel catheterization, all imaging guidance, and pulse generator initial analysis with diagnostic mode activation, when performed |
| 33277 | Insertion of phrenic nerve stimulator transvenous sensing lead (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                           |

<sup>26</sup> These codes will be maintained for the duration of the WISeR Model and could be subject to change. Any updates would be included in a future version of the WISeR Provider and Supplier Operational Guide.

<sup>27</sup> CPT codes and descriptions only are copyright 2024 American Medical Association (AMA). All rights are reserved, and applicable Federal Acquisition Regulations (FARS)/Defense Federal Acquisition Regulation Supplements (DFARS) clauses apply.

**Table A5. Electrical Nerve Stimulators (NCD 160.7)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                   |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 63655 | Laminectomy for implantation of neurostimulator electrodes, plate/paddle, epidural |

Note: Current Procedural Terminology code 63650 for implanted spinal stimulator is included in CMS' Prior Authorization Program for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services. For more information, please visit the [Prior Authorization for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services webpage](#).

**Table A6. Incontinence Control Devices (NCD 230.10)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                                                                                       |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 53440 | Sling operation for correction of male urinary incontinence (e.g., fascia or synthetic)                                                                |
| 53445 | Insertion of inflatable urethral/bladder neck sphincter, including placement of pump, reservoir, and cuff                                              |
| 53451 | Periurethral transperineal adjustable balloon continence device; bilateral insertion, including cystourethroscopy and imaging guidance                 |
| 53452 | Periurethral transperineal adjustable balloon continence device; unilateral insertion, including cystourethroscopy and imaging guidance                |
| 57288 | Placement of a sling made of fascia or synthetic material under the urethra to support it in the correct position to treat urinary stress incontinence |

**Table A7. Sacral Nerve Stimulation for Urinary Incontinence (NCD 230.18)**

| Code               | Code description                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 64561 <sup>a</sup> | Percutaneous implantation of neurostimulator electrode array; sacral nerve (transforaminal placement), including image guidance, if performed |
| 64581              | Open implantation of neurostimulator electrode array; sacral nerve (transforaminal placement)                                                 |

Note: Prior authorization for Sacral Nerve Stimulation for Urinary Incontinence will be implemented only for the indications specified in Appendix B.

<sup>a</sup> Please note that trial implantation and replacements billed under Current Procedural Terminology code 64561 do not require prior authorization or pre-payment review under WISer. CPT code 64561 is only subject to prior authorization when billed in conjunction with the generator implantation code (CPT code 64590). During pre-payment review, the presence of CPT code 64590 will be used to distinguish a permanent implantation from a trial.

**Table A8. Diagnosis and Treatment of Impotence (NCD 230.4)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                                                 |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 54400 | Insertion of penile prosthesis; non-inflatable (semi-rigid)                                                      |
| 54401 | Insertion of penile prosthesis; inflatable (self-contained)                                                      |
| 54405 | Insertion of multicomponent, inflatable penile prosthesis, including placement of pump, cylinders, and reservoir |

**Table A9. Percutaneous Vertebral Augmentation for Vertebral Compression Fracture (LCD L34228, L38201, L35130)**

| <b>Code</b> | <b>Code description</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 22510       | Percutaneous vertebroplasty (bone biopsy included when performed), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral injection, inclusive of all imaging guidance; cervicothoracic                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 22511       | Percutaneous vertebroplasty (bone biopsy included when performed), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral injection, inclusive of all imaging guidance; lumbosacral                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 22512       | Percutaneous vertebroplasty (bone biopsy included when performed), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral injection, inclusive of all imaging guidance; each additional cervicothoracic or lumbosacral vertebral body (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                             |
| 22513       | Percutaneous vertebral augmentation, including cavity creation (fracture reduction and bone biopsy included when performed) using mechanical device (e.g., kyphoplasty), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral cannulation, inclusive of all imaging guidance; thoracic                                                                                                      |
| 22514       | Percutaneous vertebral augmentation, including cavity creation (fracture reduction and bone biopsy included when performed) using mechanical device (e.g., kyphoplasty), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral cannulation, inclusive of all imaging guidance; lumbar                                                                                                        |
| 22515       | Percutaneous vertebral augmentation, including cavity creation (fracture reduction and bone biopsy included when performed) using mechanical device (e.g., kyphoplasty), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral cannulation, inclusive of all imaging guidance; each additional thoracic or lumbar vertebral body (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure) |

**Table A10. Epidural Steroid Injections for Pain Management (LCD L39015, L39240, L36920)**

| <b>Code</b>        | <b>Code description</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 62321              | Injection(s) of diagnostic or therapeutic substance(s) (e.g., anesthetic, antispasmodic, opioid, steroid, other solution), not including neurolytic substances, including needle or catheter placement, interlaminar epidural or subarachnoid, cervical or thoracic; with imaging guidance (i.e., fluoroscopy or CT) |
| 62323 <sup>a</sup> | Injection(s), of diagnostic or therapeutic substance(s) (e.g., anesthetic, antispasmodic, opioid, steroid, other solution), not including neurolytic substances, including needle or catheter placement, interlaminar epidural or subarachnoid, lumbar or sacral; with imaging guidance (i.e., fluoroscopy or CT)    |
| 64479              | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s) and/or steroid, transforaminal epidural, with imaging guidance (fluoroscopy or CT); cervical or thoracic, single level                                                                                                                                                             |
| 64480              | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s) and/or steroid, transforaminal epidural, with imaging guidance (fluoroscopy or CT); cervical or thoracic, each additional level (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                        |

| Code  | Code description                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 64483 | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s) and/or steroid, transforaminal epidural, with imaging guidance (fluoroscopy or CT); lumbar or sacral, single level                                                                      |
| 64484 | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s) and/or steroid, transforaminal epidural, with imaging guidance (fluoroscopy or CT); lumbar or sacral, each additional level (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure) |

Note: Please reference the associated Local Coverage Determination (LCD) Reference Articles for the selected LCDs for more information about ICD-10 codes that support medical necessity for this service as defined by the Medicare Administrative Contractor.

<sup>a</sup> Please note that CPT code 62323 does not require prior authorization or pre-payment review under WISer when submitted for indications other than specified in the selected LCDs, including but not limited to implantation of an intrathecal pump for treatment of pain or spasticity.

CT = computed tomography; ICD-10 = International Classification of Diseases and Related Health Programs, 10th Revision.

**Table A11. Cervical Fusion (LCD L39741, L39758, and L39793)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                                                                                |
|-------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 22554 | Arthrodesis, anterior interbody technique, including minimal discectomy to prepare interspace (other than for decompression); cervical below c2 |

Note: Current Procedural Terminology codes 22551 and 22552 for cervical fusion are included in CMS' Prior Authorization Program for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services. For more information, please visit the [Prior Authorization for Certain Hospital Outpatient Department Services webpage](#).

**Table A12. Hypoglossal Nerve Stimulation for the Treatment of Obstructive Sleep Apnea (LCD L38307, L38310, and L38385)**

| Code  | Code description                                                                                                                                                                  | Date Information (if applicable)                                 |
|-------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 64582 | Open implantation of hypoglossal nerve neurostimulator array, pulse generator, and distal respiratory sensor electrode or electrode array                                         |                                                                  |
| C8007 | Open implantation of hypoglossal nerve neurostimulator array and pulse generator, not requiring an insertion of a separate distal respiratory sensor electrode or electrode array | Subject to WISer for dates of service on or after April 6, 2026. |
| C8011 | Open implantation of hypoglossal nerve(s) neurostimulator electrode array(s) and receiver, including external power source and all system components                              | Subject to WISer for dates of service on or after April 6, 2026. |

Note: As published in the [MLN Connects® Newsletter](#) on January 22, 2026, WISer does not include CPT 64568 billed with ICD-10 code G47.33 (obstructive sleep apnea). Additionally, CMS added new HGNS HCPCS codes C8007 and C8011 to the April 2026 Integrated Outpatient Code Editor, effective January 1, 2026, as published in the [MLN Connects® Newsletter](#) on February 26, 2026. Prior authorization requests for HCPCS codes C8007 and C8011 with dates of service prior to April 6, 2026 will not be affirmed and will instead be dismissed as non-WISer services. During pre-payment medical review, claims for HCPCS codes C8007 and C8011 with dates of service prior to April 6th will be designated as ineligible for WISer. Providers with questions about billing for HGNS should contact their respective MAC.

**Table A13. Application of Bioengineered Skin Substitutes to Lower Extremity Chronic Non-Healing Wounds (LCD L35041) and Wound Application of CTPs, Lower Extremities (LCD L36690)**

WISer removed HCPCS codes C5271 through C5278 to align with the [Calendar Year 2026 Hospital Outpatient Prospective Payment System \(OPPS\) and Ambulatory Surgical Center Final Rule \(90 FR 53748\)](#) that went into effect on January 1, 2026.

| Code  | Code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 15271 | Application of skin substitute graft to trunk, arms, and/or legs; total wound surface area up to 100 sq cm; first 25 sq cm or less wound surface area                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 15272 | Application of skin substitute graft to trunk, arms, and/or legs; total wound surface area up to 100 sq cm; each additional 25 sq cm wound surface area, or part thereof (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 15273 | Application of skin substitute graft to trunk, arms, and/or legs; total wound surface area greater than or equal to 100 sq cm; first 100 sq cm wound surface area, or 1% of body area of infants and children                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 15274 | Application of skin substitute graft to trunk, arms, and/or legs; total wound surface area greater than or equal to 100 sq cm; each additional 100 sq cm wound surface area, or part thereof, or each additional 1% of body area of infants and children, or part thereof (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                        |
| 15275 | Application of skin substitute graft to face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, orbits, genitalia, hands, feet, and/or multiple digits; total wound surface area up to 100 sq cm; first 25 sq cm or less wound surface area                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 15276 | Application of skin substitute graft to face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, orbits, genitalia, hands, feet, and/or multiple digits; total wound surface area up to 100 sq cm; each additional 25 sq cm wound surface area, or part thereof (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                  |
| 15277 | Application of skin substitute graft to face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, orbits, genitalia, hands, feet, and/or multiple digits; total wound surface area greater than or equal to 100 sq cm; first 100 sq cm wound surface area, or 1% of body area of infants and children                                                                                                                         |
| 15278 | Application of skin substitute graft to face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, orbits, genitalia, hands, feet, and/or multiple digits; total wound surface area greater than or equal to 100 sq cm; each additional 100 sq cm wound surface area, or part thereof, or each additional 1% of body area of infants and children, or part thereof (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure) |

*Note:* Prior authorization for Application of Bioengineered Skin Substitutes to Lower Extremity Chronic Non-Healing Wounds and Wound Application of Cellular and Tissue Based Products, Lower Extremities will only be implemented for the indications specified in Appendix B.

CTP = Cellular and/or Tissue-Based Products.

## Appendix B. ICD-10 Indications for Relevant WISeR Items and Services as of April 24, 2026<sup>28</sup>

Please note that WISeR will align to the coding guidance as defined in the selected National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) (and LCD Reference Articles) for all selected items and services in WISeR.

**Table B1. Vagus Nerve Stimulation (VNS) (NCD 160.18)**

WISeR removed ICD-10 code G47.33 (obstructive sleep apnea) from the Provider and Supplier Operation Guide in February 2026 to align with CMS guidance issued on January 22, 2026 in its [MLN Connects® Newsletter](#) that removed ICD-10 code G47.33 as a covered indication for CPT code 64568 under NCD 160.18.

| ICD-10 code | ICD-10 code description                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| G40.011     | Localization-related (focal) (partial) idiopathic epilepsy and epileptic syndromes with seizures of localized onset, intractable, with status epilepticus    |
| G40.019     | Localization-related (focal) (partial) idiopathic epilepsy and epileptic syndromes with seizures of localized onset, intractable, without status epilepticus |
| G40.111     | Localization-related (focal) (partial) symptomatic epilepsy and epileptic syndromes with simple partial seizures, intractable, with status epilepticus       |
| G40.119     | Localization-related (focal) (partial) symptomatic epilepsy and epileptic syndromes with simple partial seizures, intractable, without status epilepticus    |
| G40.211     | Localization-related (focal) (partial) symptomatic epilepsy and epileptic syndromes with complex partial seizures, intractable, with status epilepticus      |
| G40.219     | Localization-related (focal) (partial) symptomatic epilepsy and epileptic syndromes with complex partial seizures, intractable, without status epilepticus   |
| F31.32      | Bipolar disorder, current episode depressed, moderate                                                                                                        |
| F31.4       | Bipolar disorder, current episode, depressed severe, without psychotic features                                                                              |
| F31.81      | Bipolar II disorder                                                                                                                                          |
| F32.1       | Major depressive disorder, single episode, moderate                                                                                                          |
| F32.2       | Major depressive disorder, single episode, severe without psychotic features                                                                                 |
| F33.1       | Major depressive disorder, recurrent, moderate                                                                                                               |
| F33.2       | Major depressive disorder, recurrent, severe without psychotic features                                                                                      |
| Z00.6       | Encounter for examination for normal comparison and control in clinical research program                                                                     |

<sup>28</sup> These codes will be maintained for the duration of the WISeR Model and could be subject to change. Any updates would be included in a future version of the WISeR Provider and Supplier Operational Guide. ICD-10 refers to the International Classification of Diseases and Related Health Problems, 10th Revision.



**Table B2. Sacral Nerve Stimulation (NCD 230.18)**

| ICD-10 code | ICD-10 code description                |
|-------------|----------------------------------------|
| N39.41      | Urge incontinence                      |
| N39.42      | Incontinence without sensory awareness |
| N39.46      | Mixed incontinence                     |
| R33.8       | Other retention of urine               |
| R33.9       | Retention of urine, unspecified        |
| R35.0       | Frequency of micturition               |
| R39.11      | Hesitancy of micturition               |
| R39.14      | Feeling of incomplete bladder emptying |
| R39.15      | Urgency of urination                   |

**Table B3. Application of Bioengineered Skin Substitutes to Lower Extremity Chronic Non-Healing Wounds (LCD L35041) and Wound Application of CTPs, Lower Extremities (LCD L36690)**

WISer removed ICD-10 codes L97.111-L97.826 from the Provider and Supplier Guide in April 2026 to align with the covered diagnoses specified in the Skin Substitutes LCD Billing and Coding Articles that became effective January 1, 2026.

| ICD-10 code | ICD-10 code description                                                    |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| E08.621     | Diabetes mellitus due to underlying condition with foot ulcer              |
| E09.621     | Drug or chemical induced diabetes mellitus with foot ulcer                 |
| E10.621     | Type 1 diabetes mellitus with foot ulcer                                   |
| E11.621     | Type 2 diabetes mellitus with foot ulcer                                   |
| E13.621     | Other specified diabetes mellitus with foot ulcer                          |
| I83.011     | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with ulcer of thigh                |
| I83.012     | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with ulcer of calf                 |
| I83.013     | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with ulcer of ankle                |
| I83.014     | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with ulcer of heel and midfoot     |
| I83.015     | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with ulcer other part of foot      |
| I83.018     | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with ulcer other part of lower leg |
| I83.021     | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with ulcer of thigh                 |
| I83.022     | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with ulcer of calf                  |
| I83.023     | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with ulcer of ankle                 |
| I83.024     | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with ulcer of heel and midfoot      |
| I83.025     | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with ulcer other part of foot       |
| I83.028     | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with ulcer other part of lower leg  |



| <b>ICD-10 code</b> | <b>ICD-10 code description</b>                                                                            |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I83.211            | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with both ulcer of thigh and inflammation                         |
| I83.212            | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with both ulcer of calf and inflammation                          |
| I83.213            | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with both ulcer of ankle and inflammation                         |
| I83.214            | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with both ulcer of heel and midfoot and inflammation              |
| I83.215            | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with both ulcer other part of foot and inflammation               |
| I83.218            | Varicose veins of right lower extremity with both ulcer of other part of lower extremity and inflammation |
| I83.221            | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with both ulcer of thigh and inflammation                          |
| I83.222            | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with both ulcer of calf and inflammation                           |
| I83.223            | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with both ulcer of ankle and inflammation                          |
| I83.224            | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with both ulcer of heel and midfoot and inflammation               |
| I83.225            | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with both ulcer other part of foot and inflammation                |
| I83.228            | Varicose veins of left lower extremity with both ulcer of other part of lower extremity and inflammation  |
| I87.011            | Postthrombotic syndrome with ulcer of right lower extremity                                               |
| I87.012            | Postthrombotic syndrome with ulcer of left lower extremity                                                |
| I87.013            | Postthrombotic syndrome with ulcer of bilateral lower extremity                                           |
| I87.031            | Postthrombotic syndrome with ulcer and inflammation of right lower extremity                              |
| I87.032            | Postthrombotic syndrome with ulcer and inflammation of left lower extremity                               |
| I87.033            | Postthrombotic syndrome with ulcer and inflammation of bilateral lower extremity                          |
| I87.311            | Chronic venous hypertension (idiopathic) with ulcer of right lower extremity                              |
| I87.312            | Chronic venous hypertension (idiopathic) with ulcer of left lower extremity                               |
| I87.313            | Chronic venous hypertension (idiopathic) with ulcer of bilateral lower extremity                          |
| I87.331            | Chronic venous hypertension (idiopathic) with ulcer and inflammation of right lower extremity             |
| I87.332            | Chronic venous hypertension (idiopathic) with ulcer and inflammation of left lower extremity              |

| ICD-10 code | ICD-10 code description                                                                           |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I87.333     | Chronic venous hypertension (idiopathic) with ulcer and inflammation of bilateral lower extremity |

## Appendix C. WISeR Associated Codes List as of April 24, 2026

Associated codes are related to a WISeR item or service. The associated codes in Appendix C are not designed to be treated as stand-alone services and will not require separate prior authorization or pre-payment review. Claims for associated codes will be paid (assuming all existing requirements relevant to the associated codes are met) if a primary code for a WISeR Select Item or Service is affirmed during prior authorization or approved during pre-payment review. Claims for associated codes will be denied and/or payments for associated codes will be recouped if a primary code for a WISeR Select Item or Service has a non-affirmed prior authorization or is denied during pre-payment review.

### Notes:

- Appendix C was updated in February 2026 to reflect changes to select HCPCS/CPT codes in Table C13, Application of Bioengineered Skin Substitutes to Lower Extremity Chronic Non-Healing Wounds (LCD L35041) and Wound Application of CTPs, Lower Extremities (LCD L36690)
- These codes will be maintained for the duration of the WISeR Model and could be subject to change. Any updates would be included in a future version of the WISeR Provider and Supplier Operational Guide.

**Table C1. Arthroscopic Lavage and Arthroscopic Debridement for the Osteoarthritic Knee (NCD 150.9)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01400           | Anesthesia for open or surgical arthroscopic procedures on knee joint; not otherwise specified                                                                                                                                    |
| 29877           | Arthroscopy, knee, surgical; debridement/shaving of articular cartilage (chondroplasty)                                                                                                                                           |
| 29880           | Arthroscopy, knee, surgical; with meniscectomy (medial <i>and</i> lateral, including any meniscal shaving), including debridement/shaving of articular cartilage (chondroplasty), same or separate compartment(s), when performed |
| 29881           | Arthroscopy, knee, surgical; with meniscectomy (medial <i>or</i> lateral, including any meniscal shaving), including debridement/shaving of articular cartilage (chondroplasty), same or separate compartment(s), when performed  |
| 64447           | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s), and/or steroid; femoral nerve, including imaging guidance, when performed                                                                                                                      |

**Table C2. Induced Lesions of Nerve Tracts (NCD 160.1)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 61790           | Creation of lesion by stereotactic method, percutaneous, by neurolytic agent (e.g., alcohol, thermal, electrical, radiofrequency); gasserian ganglion              |
| 64605           | Destruction by neurolytic agent, trigeminal nerve; second and third division branches at foramen ovale                                                             |
| 64610           | Destruction by neurolytic agent, trigeminal nerve; second and third division branches at foramen ovale under radiologic monitoring                                 |
| 70450           | Computed tomography (CT) scan, head or brain; without contrast material                                                                                            |
| 76000           | Fluoroscopy, 60 minutes or less                                                                                                                                    |
| 77002           | Fluoroscopic guidance for needle placement (e.g., biopsy, aspiration, injection, localization device)                                                              |
| 00222           | Anesthesia for intracranial procedures; electrocoagulation of intercranial nerve                                                                                   |
| 01991           | Anesthesia for diagnostic or therapeutic nerve blocks and injections (when block or injection is performed by a different provider); other than the prone position |

**Table C3. Vagus Nerve Stimulation (NCD 160.18)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                              |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00300           | Anesthesia for procedures on the integumentary system, muscles, and nerves of the head, scalp, and neck                                  |
| 64568           | Open implantation of cranial nerve (e.g., vagus nerve) neurostimulator electrode array and pulse generator                               |
| C1767           | Generator, neurostimulator (implantable), non-rechargeable                                                                               |
| C1778           | Lead, neurostimulator (implantable)                                                                                                      |
| C1827           | Generator, neurostimulator (implantable), non-rechargeable, with implantable stimulation lead and external paired stimulation controller |

**Table C4. Phrenic Nerve Stimulators (NCD 160.19)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00300           | Anesthesia for procedures on the integumentary system, muscles, and nerves of the head, scalp, and neck                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 33276           | Insertion of phrenic nerve stimulator system (pulse generator and stimulating lead[s]), including vessel catheterization, all imaging guidance, and pulse generator initial analysis with diagnostic mode activation, when performed                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 33277           | Insertion of phrenic nerve stimulator transvenous sensing lead (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 70360           | Radiologic examination of the pharynx and soft tissues of the neck, including lateral and anteroposterior views                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 71045           | Radiologic examination of the chest, single view                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 71046           | X-ray exam of chest; two views                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 99100           | Anesthesia services provided to a patient of extreme age, younger than 1 year or older than 70 years (list separately in addition to the primary anesthesia procedure)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 99152           | Moderate sedation services provided by the same physician or other qualified health care professional performing the diagnostic or therapeutic service that the sedation supports, requiring the presence of an independent trained observer to assist in the monitoring of the patient's level of consciousness and physiological status; initial 15 minutes of intraservice time, patient age 5 years or older |
| 99153           | Moderate sedation services provided by the same physician or other qualified healthcare professional performing the diagnostic or therapeutic service that the sedation supports, requiring the presence of an independent trained observer to assist in the monitoring of the patient's level of consciousness and physiological status; each additional 15 minutes of intraservice time                        |
| C1767           | Generator, neurostimulator (implantable), non-rechargeable                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| C1769           | Guide wire                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| C1778           | Lead, neurostimulator (implantable)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| C1787           | Patient programmer, neurostimulator                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| C1823           | Generator, neurostimulator (implantable), non-rechargeable, with transvenous sensing and stimulation leads                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| C1887           | Catheter, guiding (may include infusion/perfusion capability)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| C1892           | Introducer/sheath, guiding, intracardiac electrophysiological, fixed-curve, peel-away                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                    |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| C1894           | Introducer/sheath, other than guiding, other than intracardiac electrophysiological, non-laser |

**Table C5. Electrical Nerve Stimulators (NCD 160.7)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00300           | Anesthesia for procedures on the integumentary system, muscles, and nerves of the head, scalp, and neck                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 00620           | Anesthesia for procedures on thoracic spine and cord; not otherwise specified                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 00630           | Anesthesia for procedures in lumbar region; not otherwise specified                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 63655           | Laminectomy for implantation of neurostimulator electrodes, plate/paddle, and epidural                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 63685           | Insertion or replacement of spinal neurostimulator pulse generator or receiver, requiring pocket creation and connection between electrode array and pulse generator or receiver                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 72020           | X-ray exam of spine, single view                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 95861           | Needle electromyography; two extremities with or without related paraspinal areas                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 95870           | Needle electromyography; limited study of muscles in one extremity or non-limb (axial) muscles (unilateral or bilateral), other than thoracic paraspinal, cranial nerve-supplied muscles, or sphincter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 95938           | Short-latency somatosensory evoked potential study, stimulation of any/all peripheral nerves or skin sites, recording from the central nervous system; in upper and lower limbs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 95939           | Placement of skin electrodes and measurement of central motor stimulation in arms and legs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 95955           | Measurement of brain wave activity (EEG) outside the brain during surgery                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| 95972           | Electronic analysis of implanted neurostimulator pulse generator/transmitter (e.g., contact group[s], interleaving, amplitude, pulse width, frequency [hz], on/off cycling, burst, magnet mode, dose lockout, patient selectable parameters, responsive neurostimulation, detection algorithms, closed loop parameters, passive parameters) by physician or other qualified health care professional; with complex spinal cord or peripheral nerve (e.g., sacral nerve) neurostimulator pulse generator/transmitter programming by physician or other qualified health care professional |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| C1778           | Lead, neurostimulator (implantable)                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| C1787           | Patient programmer, neurostimulator                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| C1820           | Generator, neurostimulator (implantable), with rechargeable battery and charging system                                                                                                                                        |
| G0453           | Continuous intraoperative neurophysiology monitoring, from outside the operating room (remote or nearby), per patient (attention directed exclusively to one patient), each 15 minutes (list in addition to primary procedure) |

Note: EEG = electroencephalogram.

**Table C6. Incontinence Control Devices (NCD 230.10)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                  |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00840           | Anesthesia for intraperitoneal procedures in lower abdomen, including laparoscopy; not otherwise specified   |
| 00860           | Anesthesia for extraperitoneal procedures in lower abdomen, including urinary tract; not otherwise specified |
| 00910           | Anesthesia for transurethral procedures (including urethrocystoscopy); not otherwise specified               |
| 00920           | Anesthesia for procedures on male genitalia (including open urethral procedures); not otherwise specified    |
| 51600           | Injection procedure for x-ray imaging of bladder during voiding                                              |
| 53440           | Sling operation for correction of male urinary incontinence (e.g., fascia or synthetic)                      |
| 53444           | Insertion of tandem cuff (dual cuff)                                                                         |
| 53445           | Insertion of inflatable urethra or bladder neck sphincter                                                    |
| 53449           | Repair of inflatable urethral/bladder neck sphincter, including pump, reservoir, and cuff                    |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 53451           | Periurethral transperineal adjustable balloon continence device; bilateral insertion, including cystourethroscopy and imaging guidance                 |
| 53452           | Periurethral transperineal adjustable balloon continence device; unilateral insertion, including cystourethroscopy and imaging guidance                |
| 53454           | Periurethral transperineal adjustable balloon continence device; percutaneous adjustment of balloon(s) fluid volume                                    |
| 57288           | Placement of a sling made of fascia or synthetic material under the urethra to support it in the correct position to treat urinary stress incontinence |
| 74420           | Urography, retrograde, with or without KUB                                                                                                             |
| 74430           | Cystography, minimum of three views, radiological supervision and interpretation                                                                       |
| 76000           | Fluoroscopy, 60 minutes or less                                                                                                                        |
| 99100           | Anesthesia for patient of extreme age, younger than 1 year and older than 70                                                                           |
| C1771           | Repair device, urinary, incontinence, with sling graft                                                                                                 |
| C1781           | Mesh (implantable)                                                                                                                                     |
| C1813           | Prosthesis, penile, inflatable                                                                                                                         |
| C1815           | Prosthesis, urinary sphincter (implantable)                                                                                                            |
| C1889           | Implantable/insertable device for device-intensive procedure, not otherwise classified                                                                 |

Note: KUB = kidney, ureter, and bladder.

**Table C7. Sacral Nerve Stimulators for Urinary Incontinence (NCD 230.18)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00300           | Anesthesia for procedures on the integumentary system, muscles, and nerves of the head, scalp, and neck                                                                                                  |
| 00630           | Anesthesia for procedures in the lumbar region; not otherwise specified                                                                                                                                  |
| 64561           | Insertion of sacral nerve neurostimulator electrode array                                                                                                                                                |
| 64581           | Open implantation of neurostimulator electrode array; sacral nerve (transforaminal placement)                                                                                                            |
| 64590           | Insertion or replacement of peripheral, sacral, or gastric neurostimulator pulse generator or receiver, requiring pocket creation and connection between electrode array and pulse generator or receiver |
| 72220           | X-ray exam, sacrum and coccyx, minimum of two views                                                                                                                                                      |



| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 76000           | Fluoroscopy, 60 minutes or less                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 95972           | Electronic analysis of implanted neurostimulator pulse generator/transmitter (e.g., contact group[s], interleaving, amplitude, pulse width, frequency [hz], on/off cycling, burst, magnet mode, dose lockout, patient selectable parameters, responsive neurostimulation, detection algorithms, closed loop parameters, passive parameters) by physician or other qualified health care professional; with complex spinal cord or peripheral nerve (e.g., sacral nerve) neurostimulator pulse generator/transmitter programming by physician or other qualified health care professional |
| 99100           | Anesthesia services provided to a patient of extreme age, younger than 1 year or older than 70 years (list separately in addition to the primary anesthesia procedure)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| C1767           | Generator, neurostimulator (implantable), non-rechargeable                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| C1778           | Lead, neurostimulator (implantable)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| C1787           | Patient programmer, neurostimulator                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| C1883           | Adaptor/extension, pacing lead or neurostimulator lead (implantable)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

**Table C8. Diagnosis and Treatment of Impotence (NCD 230.4)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                          |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00920           | Anesthesia for procedures on male genitalia (including open urethral procedures); not otherwise specified                            |
| 00938           | Anesthesia for procedures on male genitalia (including open urethral procedures); insertion of penile prosthesis (perineal approach) |
| 54360           | Plastic operation on penis to correct angulation                                                                                     |
| 54400           | Insertion of penile prosthesis; non-inflatable (semi-rigid)                                                                          |
| 54401           | Insertion of penile prosthesis; inflatable (self-contained)                                                                          |
| 54405           | Insertion of multicomponent inflatable penile implant                                                                                |
| 54406           | Removal of all components of a multicomponent, inflatable penile prosthesis without replacement of prosthesis                        |
| C1813           | Prosthesis, penile, inflatable                                                                                                       |
| C1889           | Implantable/insertable device for device-intensive procedure, not otherwise classified                                               |
| C2622           | Prosthesis, penile, non-inflatable                                                                                                   |

**Table C9. Percutaneous Vertebral Augmentation for Vertebral Compression Fracture (LCD L34228, L38201, L35130)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01941           | Anesthesia for percutaneous image-guided neuromodulation or intravertebral procedures (e.g., kyphoplasty, vertebroplasty) on the spine or spinal cord; cervical or thoracic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 01942           | Anesthesia for percutaneous image-guided neuromodulation or intravertebral procedures (e.g., kyphoplasty, vertebroplasty) on the spine or spinal cord; lumbar sacral                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 22510           | Percutaneous vertebroplasty (bone biopsy included when performed), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral injection, inclusive of all imaging guidance; cervicothoracic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 22511           | Percutaneous vertebroplasty (bone biopsy included when performed), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral injection, inclusive of all imaging guidance; lumbosacral                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 22512           | Percutaneous vertebroplasty (bone biopsy included when performed), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral injection, inclusive of all imaging guidance; each additional cervicothoracic or lumbosacral vertebral body (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                           |
| 22513           | Percutaneous vertebral augmentation, including cavity creation (fracture reduction and bone biopsy included when performed) using mechanical device (e.g., kyphoplasty), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral cannulation, inclusive of all imaging guidance; thoracic                                                                                                                                    |
| 22514           | Percutaneous vertebral augmentation, including cavity creation (fracture reduction and bone biopsy included when performed) using mechanical device (e.g., kyphoplasty), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral cannulation, inclusive of all imaging guidance; lumbar                                                                                                                                      |
| 22515           | Percutaneous vertebral augmentation, including cavity creation (fracture reduction and bone biopsy included when performed) using mechanical device (e.g., kyphoplasty), one vertebral body, unilateral or bilateral cannulation, inclusive of all imaging guidance; each additional thoracic or lumbar vertebral body (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                               |
| 99152           | Moderate sedation services provided by the same physician or other qualified health care professional performing the diagnostic or therapeutic service that the sedation supports, requiring the presence of an independent trained observer to assist in the monitoring of the patient's level of consciousness and physiological status; initial 15 minutes of intraservice time, patient age 5 years or older |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 99153           | Moderate sedation services provided by the same physician or other qualified healthcare professional performing the diagnostic or therapeutic service that the sedation supports, requiring the presence of an independent trained observer to assist in the monitoring of the patient's level of consciousness and physiological status; each additional 15 minutes of intraservice time |
| C1713           | Anchor/screw for opposing bone-to-bone or soft tissue-to-bone (implantable)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| C1889           | Implantable/insertable device for device-intensive procedure; not otherwise classified                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

**Table C10. Epidural Steroid Injections for Pain Management (LCD L39015, L39240, L36920)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01937           | Anesthesia for percutaneous image-guided injection, drainage, or aspiration procedures on the spine or spinal cord; cervical or thoracic                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 62321           | Injection(s) of diagnostic or therapeutic substance(s) (e.g., anesthetic, antispasmodic, opioid, steroid, other solution), not including neurolytic substances, including needle or catheter placement, interlaminar epidural or subarachnoid, cervical or thoracic; with imaging guidance (i.e., fluoroscopy or computed tomography [CT]) |
| 62323           | Injection(s) of diagnostic or therapeutic substance(s) (e.g., anesthetic, antispasmodic, opioid, steroid, other solution), not including neurolytic substances, including needle or catheter placement, interlaminar epidural or subarachnoid, lumbar or sacral; with imaging guidance (i.e., fluoroscopy or CT)                           |
| 64479           | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s) and/or steroid, transforaminal epidural, with imaging guidance (fluoroscopy or CT); cervical or thoracic, single level                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 64480           | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s) and/or steroid, transforaminal epidural, with imaging guidance (fluoroscopy or CT); cervical or thoracic, each additional level (List separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                              |
| 64483           | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s) and/or steroid, transforaminal epidural, with imaging guidance (fluoroscopy or CT); lumbar or sacral, single level                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 64484           | Injection(s), anesthetic agent(s) and/or steroid, transforaminal epidural, with imaging guidance (fluoroscopy or CT); lumbar or sacral, each additional level (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                  |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 99152           | Moderate sedation services provided by the same physician or other qualified health care professional performing the diagnostic or therapeutic service that the sedation supports, requiring the presence of an independent trained observer to assist in the monitoring of the patient's level of consciousness and physiological status; initial 15 minutes of intraservice time, patient age 5 years or older |

**Table C11. Cervical Fusion (LCD L39741, L39758, L39793)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 20930           | Placement of fragmented bone graft or material to spine to promote bone growth                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 20931           | Graft of donor bone to spine                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 20936           | Harvest of bone from same spine incision for graft                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 22554           | Arthrodesis, anterior interbody technique, including minimal discectomy to prepare interspace (other than for decompression); cervical below c2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 22845           | Anterior instrumentation; two to three vertebral segments (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 22853           | Insertion of interbody biomechanical device(s) (e.g., synthetic cage, mesh) with integral anterior instrumentation for device anchoring (e.g., screws, flanges), when performed, to intervertebral disc space in conjunction with interbody arthrodesis, each interspace (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                     |
| 22854           | Insertion of intervertebral biomechanical device(s) (e.g., synthetic cage, mesh) with integral anterior instrumentation for device anchoring (e.g., screws, flanges), when performed, to vertebral corpectomy(ies) (vertebral body resection, partial or complete) defect, in conjunction with interbody arthrodesis, each contiguous defect (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure) |
| 63081           | Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, anterior approach with decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve root(s); cervical, single segment                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 63082           | Vertebral corpectomy (vertebral body resection), partial or complete, anterior approach with decompression of spinal cord and/or nerve root(s); cervical, each additional segment (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                                                            |
| 72020           | X-ray exam of spine, single view                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 72040           | X-ray exam of upper (neck) spine, two to three views                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 76000           | Fluoroscopy, 60 minutes or less                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 95861           | Needle electromyography; two extremities with or without related paraspinal areas                                                                                                                                               |
| 95937           | Neuromuscular junction test                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 95938           | Short-latency somatosensory evoked potential study, stimulation of any/all peripheral nerves or skin sites, recording from the central nervous system; in upper and lower limbs                                                 |
| 95939           | Placement of skin electrodes and measurement of central motor stimulation in arms and legs                                                                                                                                      |
| 95955           | Measurement of brain wave activity (EEG) outside the brain during surgery                                                                                                                                                       |
| 00600           | Anesthesia for procedures on cervical spine and cord; not otherwise specified                                                                                                                                                   |
| 00670           | Anesthesia for extensive spine and spinal cord procedures (e.g., spinal instrumentation or vascular procedures)                                                                                                                 |
| C1713           | Anchor/screw for opposing bone-to-bone or soft tissue-to-bone (implantable)                                                                                                                                                     |
| C1762           | Connective tissue, human (includes fascia lata)                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| C1889           | Implantable/insertable device for device-intensive procedure, not otherwise classified                                                                                                                                          |
| G0453           | Continuous intraoperative neurophysiology monitoring, from outside the operating room (remote or nearby), per patient, (attention directed exclusively to one patient), each 15 minutes (list in addition to primary procedure) |

Note: EEG = electroencephalogram.

**Table C12. Hypoglossal Nerve Stimulation for Obstructive Sleep Apnea (LCD L38307, L38310, L38385)**

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00300           | Anesthesia for procedures on the integumentary system, muscles, and nerves of the head, scalp, and neck                                                             |
| 42975           | Drug-induced sleep endoscopy, with dynamic evaluation of velum, pharynx, tongue base, and larynx for evaluation of sleep-disordered breathing; flexible, diagnostic |
| 64568           | Open implantation of cranial nerve (e.g., vagus nerve) neurostimulator electrode array and pulse generator                                                          |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                               |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 64582           | Open implantation of hypoglossal nerve neurostimulator array, pulse generator, and distal respiratory sensor electrode or electrode array |
| 70360           | Radiologic examination of the pharynx and soft tissues of the neck, including lateral and anteroposterior views                           |
| 71045           | Radiologic examination of the chest, single view                                                                                          |
| C1767           | Generator, neurostimulator (implantable), non-rechargeable                                                                                |
| C1778           | Lead, neurostimulator (implantable)                                                                                                       |
| C1787           | Patient programmer, neurostimulator                                                                                                       |

**Table C13. Application of Bioengineered Skin Substitutes to Lower Extremity Chronic Non-Healing Wounds (LCD L35041) and Wound Application of CTPs, Lower Extremities (LCD L36690)**

WISer removed CPT codes C5271 through C5278 to align with the [Calendar Year 2026 Hospital Outpatient Prospective Payment System \(OPPS\) and Ambulatory Surgical Center Final Rule \(90 FR 53748\)](#) that went into effect on January 1, 2026.

WISer removed HCPCS codes Q4100 and Q4106 to align with quarterly HCPCS update files effective January 1, 2026.

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00300           | Anesthesia for procedures on the integumentary system, muscles, and nerves of the head, scalp, and neck                                                                                                        |
| 00400           | Anesthesia for procedures on the integumentary system on the extremities, anterior trunk, and perineum; not otherwise specified                                                                                |
| 01480           | Anesthesia for other procedure on lower leg, ankle, and foot bones                                                                                                                                             |
| 15002           | Preparation of skin graft site of trunk, arms, or legs; 100.0 sq cm or 1% body area for infants and children, or less                                                                                          |
| 15003           | Preparation of skin graft site of trunk, arms, or legs; each additional 100.0 sq cm or 1% body area for infants and children, or less                                                                          |
| 15004           | Preparation of skin graft site of face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, around eyes, genitals, hands, feet, fingers, or toes; 100.0 sq cm or 1% body area for infants and children, or less                 |
| 15005           | Preparation of skin graft site of face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, around eyes, genitals, hands, feet, fingers, or toes; each additional 100.0 sq cm or 1% body area for infants and children, or less |
| 15271           | Application of skin substitute graft to wound of trunk, arms, or legs; 25.0 sq cm or less of wound, 100.0 sq cm or less                                                                                        |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 15272           | Application of skin substitute graft to trunk, arms, or legs; total wound surface area up to 100 sq cm; each additional 25 sq cm wound surface area, or part thereof (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 15273           | Application of skin substitute graft to trunk, arms, or legs; total wound surface area greater than or equal to 100 sq cm; first 100 sq cm wound surface area, or 1% of body area of infants and children                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 15274           | Application of skin substitute graft to trunk, arms, or legs; total wound surface area greater than or equal to 100 sq cm; each additional 100 sq cm wound surface area, or part thereof, or each additional 1% of body area of infants and children, or part thereof (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                            |
| 15275           | Application of skin substitute graft to face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, orbits, genitalia, hands, feet, and/or multiple digits; total wound surface area up to 100 sq cm; first 25 sq cm or less wound surface area                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 15276           | Application of skin substitute graft to face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, orbits, genitalia, hands, feet, and/or multiple digits; total wound surface area up to 100 sq cm; each additional 25 sq cm wound surface area, or part thereof (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure)                                                                                                  |
| 15277           | Application of skin substitute graft to face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, orbits, genitalia, hands, feet, and/or multiple digits; total wound surface area greater than or equal to 100 sq cm; first 100 sq cm wound surface area or 1% of body area of infants and children                                                                                                                          |
| 15278           | Application of skin substitute graft to face, scalp, eyelids, mouth, neck, ears, orbits, genitalia, hands, feet, and/or multiple digits; total wound surface area greater than or equal to 100 sq cm; each additional 100 sq cm wound surface area, or part thereof, or each additional 1% of body area of infants and children, or part thereof (list separately in addition to code for primary procedure) |
| A2001           | InnovaMatrix AC, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| A2002           | Mirragen Advanced Wound Matrix, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| A2005           | Microlyte Matrix, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| A2006           | NovoSorb SynPath dermal matrix, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| A2007           | Restrata, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| A2008           | TheraGenesis, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| A2009           | Symphony, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| A2010           | APIS, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| A2011           | Supra SDRM, per square centimeter                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

| <b>Associated code</b> | <b>Associated code description</b>                                                                                |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A2012                  | SUPRATHEL, per square centimeter                                                                                  |
| A2013                  | InnovaMatrix FS, per square centimeter                                                                            |
| A2015                  | Phoenix wound matrix, per square centimeter                                                                       |
| A2016                  | PermeaDerm B, per square centimeter                                                                               |
| A2018                  | PermeaDerm C, per square centimeter                                                                               |
| A2019                  | Kerecis Omega3 MariGen shield, per square centimeter                                                              |
| A2021                  | NeoMatrix, per square centimeter                                                                                  |
| A2022                  | InnovaBurn or InnovaMatrix XL, per square centimeter                                                              |
| A2024                  | Resolve matrix, per square centimeter                                                                             |
| A2027                  | MatriDerm, per square centimeter                                                                                  |
| A4100                  | Skin substitute, Federal Drug Administration cleared as a device; not otherwise specified                         |
| Q4101                  | Apligraf, per square centimeter                                                                                   |
| Q4102                  | Oasis wound matrix, per square centimeter                                                                         |
| Q4103                  | Oasis burn matrix, per square centimeter                                                                          |
| Q4104                  | Integra Bilayer Matrix Wound Dressing (BMWD), per square centimeter                                               |
| Q4105                  | Integra Dermal Regeneration Template (DRT) or Integra Omnigraft Dermal Regeneration Matrix, per square centimeter |
| Q4107                  | GraftJacket, per square centimeter                                                                                |
| Q4108                  | Integra Wound Matrix, per square centimeter                                                                       |
| Q4110                  | PriMatrix, per square centimeter                                                                                  |
| Q4111                  | GammaGraft, per square centimeter                                                                                 |
| Q4115                  | AlloSkin, per square centimeter                                                                                   |
| Q4116                  | AlloDerm, per square centimeter                                                                                   |
| Q4117                  | Hyalomatrix, per square centimeter                                                                                |
| Q4121                  | TheraSkin, per square centimeter                                                                                  |
| Q4122                  | Dermacell, Dermacell AWN or Dermacell AWN Porous, per square centimeter                                           |
| Q4123                  | AlloSkin RT, per square centimeter                                                                                |
| Q4124                  | Oasis Ultra Tri-Layer Wound Matrix, per square centimeter                                                         |
| Q4125                  | ArthroFlex, per square centimeter                                                                                 |
| Q4126                  | MemoDerm, DermaSpan, TranzGraft, or Integuply, per square centimeter                                              |



| <b>Associated code</b> | <b>Associated code description</b>                                                    |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q4127                  | Talymed, per square centimeter                                                        |
| Q4128                  | FlexHD or AlloPatch HD, per square centimeter                                         |
| Q4130                  | Strattice TM, per square centimeter                                                   |
| Q4132                  | GRAFIX CORE and Graftix PL CORE, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4133                  | GRAFIX PRIME, GRAFIX PL PRIME, STRAVIX, and STRAVIX PL, per square centimeter         |
| Q4134                  | hMatrix, per square centimeter                                                        |
| Q4135                  | mediSKIN, per square centimeter                                                       |
| Q4136                  | EZ-Derm, per square centimeter                                                        |
| Q4137                  | AmnioExcel, AmnioExcel Plus, or Biodexcel, per square centimeter                      |
| Q4138                  | BioDFence DryFlex, per square centimeter                                              |
| Q4140                  | BioDFence, per square centimeter                                                      |
| Q4141                  | AlloSkin AC, per square centimeter                                                    |
| Q4142                  | XCM Biologic Tissue Matrix, per square centimeter                                     |
| Q4143                  | Repriza, per square centimeter                                                        |
| Q4146                  | Tensix, per square centimeter                                                         |
| Q4147                  | Architect, Architect PX, or Architect FX, extracellular matrix, per square centimeter |
| Q4148                  | Neox CORD 1K, Neox CORD RT, or Clarix Cord 1K, per square centimeter                  |
| Q4150                  | AlloWrap DS or Dry, per square centimeter                                             |
| Q4151                  | AmnioBand or Guardian, per square centimeter                                          |
| Q4152                  | DermaPure, per square centimeter                                                      |
| Q4153                  | Dermavest and Plurivest, per square centimeter                                        |
| Q4154                  | Biovance, per square centimeter                                                       |
| Q4156                  | Neox 100 or Clarix 100, per square centimeter                                         |
| Q4157                  | REVITALON, per square centimeter                                                      |
| Q4158                  | Kerecis Omega3, per square centimeter                                                 |
| Q4159                  | Affinity, per square centimeter                                                       |
| Q4160                  | NuShield, per square centimeter                                                       |
| Q4161                  | bio-ConneKt Wound Matrix, per square centimeter                                       |
| Q4163                  | Woundex, BioSkin, per square centimeter                                               |

| <b>Associated code</b> | <b>Associated code description</b>                |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Q4164                  | Helicoll, per square centimeter                   |
| Q4165                  | Keramatrix or Kerasorb, per square centimeter     |
| Q4166                  | Cytal, per square centimeter                      |
| Q4167                  | TruSkin, per square centimeter                    |
| Q4169                  | Artacent Wound, per square centimeter             |
| Q4170                  | Cygnus, per square centimeter                     |
| Q4173                  | PalinGen or PalinGen XPlus, per square centimeter |
| Q4175                  | MiroDerm, per square centimeter                   |
| Q4176                  | NeoPatch or Therion, per square centimeter        |
| Q4178                  | FlowerAmnioPatch, per square centimeter           |
| Q4179                  | FlowerDerm, per square centimeter                 |
| Q4180                  | Revita, per square centimeter                     |
| Q4181                  | Amnio wound, per square centimeter                |
| Q4182                  | TransCyte, per square centimeter                  |
| Q4183                  | Surgigraft, per square centimeter                 |
| Q4184                  | Cellesta or Cellesta Duo, per square centimeter   |
| Q4186                  | EPIFIX, per square centimeter                     |
| Q4187                  | EPICORD, per square centimeter                    |
| Q4188                  | AmnioArmor, per square centimeter                 |
| Q4190                  | Artacent AC, per square centimeter                |
| Q4191                  | Restorigin, per square centimeter                 |
| Q4193                  | Coll-e-Derm, per square centimeter                |
| Q4194                  | Novachor, per square centimeter                   |
| Q4195                  | PuraPly, per square centimeter                    |
| Q4196                  | PuraPly AM, per square centimeter                 |
| Q4197                  | PuraPly XT, per square centimeter                 |
| Q4198                  | Genesis Amniotic Membrane, per square centimeter  |
| Q4199                  | CYGNUS Matrix, per square centimeter              |
| Q4200                  | SkinTE, per square centimeter                     |
| Q4201                  | Matrion, per square centimeter                    |

| <b>Associated code</b> | <b>Associated code description</b>                                                                        |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q4203                  | Derma-Gide, per square centimeter                                                                         |
| Q4204                  | XWRAP, per square centimeter                                                                              |
| Q4205                  | Membrane graft or membrane wrap, per square centimeter                                                    |
| Q4208                  | Novafix, per square centimeter                                                                            |
| Q4209                  | SurGraft, per square centimeter                                                                           |
| Q4211                  | Amnion bio or AxoBioMembrane, per square centimeter                                                       |
| Q4214                  | Cellesta Cord, per square centimeter                                                                      |
| Q4216                  | Artacent Cord, per square centimeter                                                                      |
| Q4217                  | WoundFix, BioWound, WoundFix Plus, BioWound Plus, WoundFix Xplus or BioWound XPlus, per square centimeter |
| Q4218                  | SurgiCORD, per square centimeter                                                                          |
| Q4219                  | SurgiGRAFT-DUAL, per square centimeter                                                                    |
| Q4220                  | BellaCell HD or SureDerm, per square centimeter                                                           |
| Q4221                  | AmnioWrap2, per square centimeter                                                                         |
| Q4222                  | ProgenaMatrix, per square centimeter                                                                      |
| Q4225                  | AmnioBand, per square centimeter                                                                          |
| Q4226                  | MyOwn Skin, includes harvesting and preparation procedures, per square centimeter                         |
| Q4227                  | AmnioCore, per square centimeter                                                                          |
| Q4229                  | Cogenex Amniotic Membrane, per square centimeter                                                          |
| Q4232                  | Corplex, per square centimeter                                                                            |
| Q4234                  | Xcellerate, per square centimeter                                                                         |
| Q4235                  | AmnioRepair or AltiPly, per square centimeter                                                             |
| Q4236                  | carePATCH, per square centimeter                                                                          |
| Q4237                  | Cryo-Cord, per square centimeter                                                                          |
| Q4238                  | Derm-Maxx, per square centimeter                                                                          |
| Q4239                  | Amnio-Maxx or Amnio-Maxx lite, per square centimeter                                                      |
| Q4247                  | AmnioText Patch, per square centimeter                                                                    |
| Q4248                  | Dermacyte Amniotic Membrane Allograft, per square centimeter                                              |
| Q4249                  | AmniPly, for topical use only, per square centimeter                                                      |
| Q4250                  | AmnioAMP-MP, per square centimeter                                                                        |

| <b>Associated code</b> | <b>Associated code description</b>                               |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q4251                  | VIM, per square centimeter                                       |
| Q4252                  | Vendaje, per square centimeter                                   |
| Q4253                  | Zenith Amniotic Membrane, per square centimeter                  |
| Q4254                  | Novafix DL, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4255                  | REGUaRD, for topical use only, per square centimeter             |
| Q4256                  | MLG-Complete, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4257                  | Relese, per square centimeter                                    |
| Q4258                  | Enverse, per square centimeter                                   |
| Q4259                  | Celera Dual Layer or Celera Dual Membrane, per square centimeter |
| Q4260                  | Signature APatch, per square centimeter                          |
| Q4261                  | TAG, per square centimeter                                       |
| Q4262                  | Dual Layer Impax Membrane, per square centimeter                 |
| Q4263                  | SurGraft TL, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4264                  | Cocoon membrane, per square centimeter                           |
| Q4265                  | NeoStim TL, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4266                  | NeoStim Membrane, per square centimeter                          |
| Q4267                  | NeoStim DL, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4268                  | SurGraft FT, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4269                  | SurGraft XT, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4270                  | Complete SL, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4271                  | Complete FT, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4272                  | Esano A, per square centimeter                                   |
| Q4273                  | Esano AAA, per square centimeter                                 |
| Q4274                  | Esano AC, per square centimeter                                  |
| Q4275                  | Esano ACA, per square centimeter                                 |
| Q4276                  | Orion, per square centimeter                                     |
| Q4278                  | EPIEFFECT, per square centimeter                                 |
| Q4279                  | Vendaje AC, per sq cm N Low                                      |
| Q4280                  | Xcell Amnio Matrix, per square centimeter                        |
| Q4281                  | Barrera SL or Barrera DL, per square centimeter                  |

| Associated code | Associated code description                              |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Q4282           | CYGNUS Dual, per square centimeter                       |
| Q4283           | Biovance Tri-Layer or Biovance 3L, per square centimeter |
| Q4284           | DermaBind SL, per square centimeter                      |
| Q4285           | NuDYN DL or NuDYN DL MESH, per square centimeter         |
| Q4286           | NuDYN SL or NuDYN SLW, per square centimeter             |
| Q4287           | DermaBind DL, per sq cm N Low                            |
| Q4288           | DermaBind CH, per sq cm N Low                            |
| Q4289           | RevoShield+ Amnio, per sq cm N Low                       |
| Q4290           | Membrane Wrap Hydro per sq cm N Low                      |
| Q4291           | Lamellas XT, per sq cm N Low                             |
| Q4292           | Lamellas, per sq cm N Low                                |
| Q4293           | Acesso DL, per sq cm N Low                               |
| Q4294           | Amnio quad-core, per sq cm                               |
| Q4295           | Amnio tri-core, per sq cm N Low                          |
| Q4296           | Rebound matrix, per sq cm N Low                          |
| Q4297           | Emerge matrix, per sq cm N Low                           |
| Q4298           | Amnicore pro, per sq cm N Low                            |
| Q4299           | Amnicore pro+, per sq cm N Low                           |
| Q4300           | Acesso TL, per sq cm N Low                               |
| Q4301           | Activate Matrix, per sq cm N Low                         |
| Q4302           | Complete ACA, per sq cm N Low                            |
| Q4303           | Complete AA, per sq cm N Low                             |
| Q4304           | Grafix Plus, per sq cm N                                 |
| Q4305           | American Amnion AC Tri-Layer per sq cm                   |
| Q4306           | American Amnion AC per sq cm                             |
| Q4307           | American Amnion, per sq cm                               |
| Q4308           | Sanopellis, per sq cm                                    |
| Q4309           | VIA Matrix, per sq cm                                    |
| Q4311           | Acesso, per square centimeter                            |
| Q4312           | Acesso AC, per square centimeter                         |

| <b>Associated code</b> | <b>Associated code description</b>                            |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q4313                  | DermaBind FM, per square centimeter                           |
| Q4314                  | Reeva FT, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4315                  | RegeneLink Amniotic Membrane Allograft, per square centimeter |
| Q4316                  | AmchoPlast, per square centimeter                             |
| Q4317                  | VitoGraft, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4318                  | E-Graft, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4319                  | SanoGraft, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4320                  | PelloGraft, per square centimeter                             |
| Q4321                  | RenoGraft, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4322                  | caregraFT, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4323                  | alloPLY, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4324                  | AmnioTX, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4325                  | ACApatch, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4326                  | WoundPlus, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4327                  | DuoAmnion, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4328                  | MOST, per square centimeter                                   |
| Q4329                  | Singlay, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4330                  | TOTAL, per square centimeter                                  |
| Q4331                  | Axolotl Graft, per square centimeter                          |
| Q4332                  | Axolotl DualGraft, per square centimeter                      |
| Q4333                  | ArdeoGraft, per square centimeter                             |
| Q4334                  | Amnioplast 1, per square centimeter                           |
| Q4335                  | Amnioplast 2, per square centimeter                           |
| Q4336                  | Artacent C, per square centimeter                             |
| Q4337                  | Artacent Trident, per square centimeter                       |
| Q4338                  | Artacent Velos, per square centimeter                         |
| Q4339                  | Artacent VeriClen, per square centimeter                      |
| Q4340                  | SimpliGraft, per square centimeter                            |
| Q4341                  | Simplimax, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4342                  | Theramend, per square centimeter                              |

| Associated code | Associated code description                                            |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q4343           | Dermacyte AC Matrix Amniotic Membrane Allograft, per square centimeter |
| Q4344           | Tri-Membrane Wrap, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4345           | Matrix HD Allograft Dermis, per square centimeter                      |
| Q4346           | Shelter DM Matrix, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4347           | Rampart DL Matrix, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4348           | Sentry SL Matrix, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4349           | Mantle DL Matrix, per square centimeter                                |
| Q4350           | Palisade DM Matrix, per square centimeter                              |
| Q4351           | Enclose TL Matrix, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4352           | Overlay SL Matrix, per square centimeter                               |
| Q4353           | Xceed TL Matrix, per square centimeter                                 |
| Q4354           | PalinGen Dual Layer sq cm                                              |
| Q4355           | Abiomend Xplus, Abiomend Xplus Hydromembrane per sq cm                 |
| Q4356           | Abiomend, Abiomend Hydromembrane per sq cm                             |
| Q4357           | XWRAP Plus, per sq cm                                                  |
| Q4358           | XWRAP Dual, per sq cm                                                  |
| Q4359           | Choripty, per sq cm                                                    |
| Q4360           | AmchoPlast FD per sq cm                                                |
| Q4361           | EPIXPRESS, per sq cm                                                   |
| Q4362           | CYGNUS Disk, per sq cm                                                 |
| Q4363           | Amnio Burgeon Membrane and Hydromembrane, per sq cm                    |
| Q4364           | Amnio Burgeon Xplus Membrane and Xplus Hydromembrane, per sq cm        |
| Q4365           | Amnio Burgeon Dual-Layer Membrane, per sq cm                           |
| Q4366           | Dual Layer Amnio Burgeon X-Membrane, per sq cm                         |
| Q4367           | AmnioCore SL, per sq cm                                                |
| Q4368           | AmchoThick, per sq cm                                                  |
| Q4369           | AmnioPlast 3, per sq cm                                                |
| Q4370           | AeroGuard per sq cm                                                    |
| Q4371           | NeoGuard per sq cm                                                     |
| Q4372           | AmchoPlast EXCEL, per sq cm                                            |

| <b>Associated code</b> | <b>Associated code description</b> |
|------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Q4373                  | Membrane Wrap-Lite, per sq cm      |
| Q4375                  | DuoGRAFT AC, per sq cm             |
| Q4376                  | Duograft AA, per sq cm             |
| Q4377                  | TriGRAFT FT, per sq cm             |
| Q4378                  | Renew FT Matrix, per sq cm         |
| Q4379                  | AmnioDefend FT, per sq cm          |
| Q4380                  | AdvoGraft One, per sq cm           |
| Q4382                  | AdvoGraft Dual, per sq cm          |



## Appendix D. Acronym Glossary

| Acronym | Definition                                                                          |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ABN     | Advanced Beneficiary Notice of Non-Coverage                                         |
| ACC     | American College of Cardiology                                                      |
| ADR     | Additional documentation request                                                    |
| AHA     | American Heart Association                                                          |
| AHI     | Apnea-hypopnea index                                                                |
| ASC     | Ambulatory Surgical Center                                                          |
| ASV     | Adaptive servo-ventilation                                                          |
| BiPAP   | Bilevel positive airway pressure                                                    |
| BMI     | Body mass index                                                                     |
| CCN     | CMS Certification Number                                                            |
| CED     | Coverage with Evidence Development                                                  |
| CFR     | Code of Federal Regulations                                                         |
| CMMI    | Center for Medicare and Medicaid Innovation                                         |
| CMS     | Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services                                            |
| CPAP    | Continuous positive airway pressure                                                 |
| CPT     | Current Procedural Terminology                                                      |
| CRT     | Cardiac resynchronization therapy                                                   |
| CTPs    | Cellular and/or Tissue-Based Products                                               |
| CSA     | Central sleep apnea                                                                 |
| esMD    | Electronic Submission of Medical Documentation                                      |
| FISS    | Fiscal Intermediary Shared System                                                   |
| GDMT    | Guideline-directed medical therapy                                                  |
| HCPCS   | Healthcare Common Procedure Coding System                                           |
| HF      | Heart failure                                                                       |
| HGNS    | Hypoglossal nerve stimulation                                                       |
| ICD     | Implantable cardioverter-defibrillator                                              |
| ICD-10  | International Classification of Diseases and Related Health Problems, 10th Revision |
| LCD     | Local Coverage Determination                                                        |
| LSS     | Lumbar Spinal Stenosis                                                              |
| LVEF    | Left ventricular ejection fraction                                                  |
| MAC     | Medicare Administrative Contractor                                                  |
| MDE     | Major depressive episode                                                            |
| NCD     | National Coverage Determination                                                     |
| NPI     | National Provider Identifier                                                        |
| NYHA    | New York Heart Association                                                          |
| OPD     | Outpatient Department                                                               |
| OPPS    | Outpatient Prospective Payment System                                               |
| PILD    | Percutaneous image-guided lumbar decompression                                      |
| POS     | Place of Service                                                                    |
| PTAN    | Provider Transaction Access Number                                                  |
| PVA     | Percutaneous Vertebral Augmentation                                                 |
| REF     | Prior authorization reference                                                       |

| <b>Acronym</b> | <b>Definition</b>                                  |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| SOC            | Standard of care                                   |
| TIA            | Transient ischemic attack                          |
| UTN            | Unique Tracking Number                             |
| VCF            | Vertebral compression fracture                     |
| VNS            | Vagus nerve stimulation                            |
| WISeR Model    | Wasteful and Inappropriate Service Reduction Model |